ENGLISH FOR WORK / ENGLISH FOR PUBLIC SERVICE PROFESSIONALS

Government and Public Administration English

Explain the process clearly. Make public decisions understandable.



Phil Stilwell

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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

01 Policy Implementation and Program Rules, page 4

Explain document status and a current requirement without confusing a preliminary check with a formal eligibility decision.

02 Public Meetings and Stakeholder Input, page 14

Apply an announced participation process consistently while acknowledging disagreement and preserving the public record.

03 Procurement and Vendor Selection, page 27

Connect a procurement recommendation to published criteria, comparable evidence, and an authorized decision process.

04 Grants, Compliance, and Reporting, page 38

Reconcile expenditure categories to supporting records and explain an unresolved difference without inventing a balancing entry.

05 Interagency Coordination, page 52

Assign distinct responsibilities across agencies and confirm a handoff without implying that the underlying service is approved.

06 Constituent Services and Escalation, page 63

Repair a misdirected service request by explaining jurisdiction, confirming a referral, and preserving a separate complaint route.

07 Transparency, Records, and Ethics, page 77

Explain a federal records-review status without promising full release or using a possible exemption as a blanket refusal.

08 Performance Metrics and Budget Justification, page 89

Explain outputs, response rates, and observed outcomes while keeping a budget request separate from a causal success claim.

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Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

Clear service without unsupported promises

Public administration combines procedural accuracy with accessible explanations. These conversations practice explaining what a document means, what an office can do, who owns the next step, and what the evidence actually establishes.

Name the document and its status

A proposal, current guidance, application receipt, and formal decision do different jobs. Identify the relevant version and status before explaining its consequence.
"That document is a proposal; the current application guidance has not changed."

Explain the boundary and the route forward

A resident needs more than a statement that an issue belongs elsewhere. Name the responsible office, explain the referral, and confirm how the handoff will be tracked.
"The permit team decides that issue; I will confirm that it has received your referral."

Keep judgments traceable to evidence

A procurement conclusion, grant total, or performance claim should point to a defined criterion and supporting record. A confident label does not replace the reasoning.
"Which published criterion does that strength address?"

Respect participation and privacy together

Fair access to a process does not mean publishing every personal detail. Use the announced participation arrangements and the applicable information-handling rules.
"We can record the issue without reading your personal details into the meeting record."

Professional boundaries

All programs, residents, offices, applications, figures, meetings, and local procedures are fictional. This is professional-English instruction, not legal advice or authority to decide eligibility, award contracts, release records, or spend funds. U.S. federal references support selected terminology; their rules do not automatically govern every local, state, tribal, or international office.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / POLICY IMPLEMENTATION AND PROGRAM RULES

Explain document status and a current requirement without confusing a preliminary check with a formal eligibility decision.

> **The proposal has not changed the current application test**
>
> The fictional Brookfield Training Grant currently requires 12 months of residence, plus other conditions. Published guidance G4 explains the current requirements. A separate proposal P2 would reduce the residence period to six months, but it has not been adopted and has no effective date. Resident Amina has lived in the area for nine months and brings P2 to the service desk. Program officer Theo must identify the current residence requirement, explain the proposal accurately, and avoid either promising an award or treating this conversation as a formal denial of an application.

People: Amina, Resident; Theo, Program information officer.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which document explains the current requirements?

A. A future decision not yet issued
B. A resident's summary of P2
C. Guidance G4
D. Proposal P2

2. What does P2 propose?

A. Removing all other conditions
B. Reducing the residence period to six months
C. Reducing it to nine months immediately
D. Awarding every submitted application

3. What can Theo accurately say about nine months?

A. It satisfies the current residence condition.
B. It establishes a complete formal eligibility decision.
C. It guarantees eligibility once P2 is discussed.
D. It is below the current 12-month residence condition.

Answers and explanations, page 117

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

program rule
A requirement governing a defined public program.

explain the program rules

current guidance
Published explanatory material reflecting the presently applicable position.

consult current guidance

draft guidance
Preliminary explanatory material not yet issued as the final version.

identify draft guidance

effective date
The date a measure begins to apply under its terms.

check the effective date

transition provision
A rule addressing movement from an old arrangement to a new one.

check transition provisions

application intake
Receipt and initial handling of an application.

arrange application intake

eligibility criterion
A condition used to decide whether an applicant qualifies.

verify an eligibility criterion

proposal
A suggested change that has not necessarily been adopted.

distinguish the proposal

adoption
Formal acceptance of a proposed measure through the applicable process.

confirm adoption

implementation date
The planned or required start of operational delivery.

confirm the implementation date

residence requirement
A condition concerning where or how long a person has lived.

explain the residence requirement

completeness check
A check that required application information is present.

perform a completeness check

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

program rule PROGRAM RULE

explain the program rules

Keep the meaning precise: A requirement governing a defined public program.

adoption ADOPTION

confirm adoption

Keep the meaning precise: Formal acceptance of a proposed measure through the applicable process.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

eligibility determination

An authorized decision about qualification under the applicable criteria.

issue an eligibility determination

supporting evidence

Documents or information used to substantiate a claim.

identify supporting evidence

verification

Checking information against appropriate evidence.

complete verification

exception

A defined departure from a general requirement where permitted.

check an authorized exception

discretion

Authorized judgment within the limits of a rule or role.

exercise defined discretion

statutory authority

Power granted by legislation.

identify statutory authority

rulemaking

The process of developing and issuing regulations.

follow the rulemaking process

public comment

Input submitted through an announced public consultation process.

submit public comment

comment deadline

The closing time for input under a specified process.

verify the comment deadline

notice

An official communication about a process, action, or decision.

read the notice

superseded version

A document version replaced by a later applicable version.

identify a superseded version

case-specific advice

Guidance tailored to a person's facts within the provider's authority.

seek case-specific advice

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

completeness check COMPLETENESS CHECK

perform a completeness check

Keep the meaning precise: A check that required application information is present.

discretion DISCRETION

exercise defined discretion

Keep the meaning precise: Authorized judgment within the limits of a rule or role.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the confusion

I can see why these two documents are easy to confuse.

Name the proposal

P2 is a proposed change, not an adopted rule.

State the proposed change

The proposal would reduce that period to six months.

Apply the stated comparison

Nine months is below the current residence requirement.

Avoid a guarantee

I cannot promise an award based on the proposal.

Ask about the source

Which document and version are you reading?

Check for authority

We should not invent an exception that the rules do not provide.

Point to the notice

The official notice explains how to submit comments.

Identify the current source

G4 explains the requirements that currently apply.

State the current condition

The current residence requirement is twelve months.

Qualify the future

No effective date has been established for P2.

Keep the decision boundary

This explanation is not a formal eligibility determination.

Preserve other criteria

The program also has other conditions to assess.

Explain the process

I can show you the current application and review steps.

Separate participation

A comment on the proposal is not a grant application.

Close with a clear distinction

Use G4 for the current requirements and P2 for the proposed change.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State the current condition
Useful wording: The current residence requirement is twelve months.

Purpose: State the proposed change
Useful wording: The proposal would reduce that period to six months.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which explanation is accurate?

A. P2 has already removed the other criteria.

B. P2 proposes six months; G4 still describes the current twelve-month condition.

C. P2's publication immediately replaced G4.

D. Nine months qualifies because it lies between six and twelve.

2. Which response avoids an unauthorized decision?

A. Nine months is below the current condition; I can explain the formal review process.

B. This conversation is your final denial notice.

C. I approve the award under the future rule.

D. I will create an exception because the proposal seems likely.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A suggested change that has not necessarily been adopted. Which term fits?

A. transition provision

B. comment deadline

C. proposal

D. verification

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The proposal has not changed the current application test". Amina: "Does the date at the top of P2 mean the shorter period started then?" Theo: [missing response] Amina: "So my nine months does not meet the condition you are using at the moment?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will. The application intake information will explain what to submit and how the review proceeds. Today's explanation neither guarantees an award nor substitutes for that formal process.

B. That is the publication date, not an effective date. No effective date has been established for this proposal. We should not tell applicants that the six-month condition already applies.

C. No. A public comment concerns the proposal. It does not itself submit a grant application. The official notice explains the comment route and the deadline for that process.

D. We would need to read any transition provision in the adopted measure. We cannot invent how pending applications would be handled before the actual terms and dates are available.

Answers and explanations, page 117

One useful distinction

A proposal may be public without being in effect. A publication date does not necessarily establish adoption or applicability. Here G4 describes the current condition, while P2 remains an unadopted proposal with no effective date.

E Conversation

The proposal has not changed the current application test

The proposal has not changed the current application test

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

proposal / eligibility determination / application intake / eligibility criterion / adoption / current guidance / transition provision / residence requirement / effective date / public comment

01 **Amina:** This came from your grant page. It says six months of residence, and I have been here nine. Have I been using the wrong application guidance?

02 **Theo:** Let us check the [1] _____ you are holding. This is P2, which suggests a change. G4 is the guidance describing the requirements that currently apply.

03 **Amina:** Both files look official. I took the shorter period to mean the rules had changed. Nothing on this printout explains the difference to me.

04 **Theo:** I understand the confusion. The [2] _____ still describes a twelve-month residence requirement. P2 would reduce that to six months, but the proposal has not been adopted.

05 **Amina:** Does the date at the top of P2 mean the shorter period started then?

06 **Theo:** That is the publication date, not an [3] _____. No effective date has been established for this proposal. We should not tell applicants that the six-month condition already applies.

07 **Amina:** So my nine months does not meet the condition you are using at the moment?

08 **Theo:** It is below the current [4] _____ of twelve months. That explains this particular condition, but it is not a formal decision on an application or a complete assessment of your circumstances.

09 **Amina:** I do not want a question at the desk to be recorded as a final rejection. I am trying to understand the process.

10 **Theo:** This is not an [5] _____. I can show you the actual application and review steps, including where to obtain case-specific information within the program's process.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The proposal has not changed the current application test

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Amina:** Are there other conditions beyond residence? The proposal headline makes the program sound much simpler.

12 **Theo:** Yes. Residence is one [6] _____, not the entire test. The current guidance lists the other requirements, and an award should not be promised from one headline.

13 **Amina:** If the proposal is adopted later, should I assume it will apply to every application already on file?

14 **Theo:** We would need to read any [7] _____ in the adopted measure. We cannot invent how pending applications would be handled before the actual terms and dates are available.

15 **Amina:** I would like to support the change. Is submitting a comment the same as asking to receive the grant?

16 **Theo:** No. A [8] _____ concerns the proposal. It does not itself submit a grant application. The official notice explains the comment route and the deadline for that process.

17 **Amina:** Then I should keep the two documents separate and not rely on the proposed six-month period for the current requirements.

18 **Theo:** Exactly. Check the [9] _____ status before treating a change as operative. Until then, use G4 for the current program explanation and P2 for the suggested change.

19 **Amina:** Thank you. Please show me where the current application steps are, and I will read the proposal notice separately.

20 **Theo:** I will. The [10] _____ information will explain what to submit and how the review proceeds. Today's explanation neither guarantees an award nor substitutes for that formal process.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. proposal / **2.** current guidance / **3.** effective date / **4.** residence requirement / **5.** eligibility determination / **6.** eligibility criterion / **7.** transition provision / **8.** public comment / **9.** adoption / **10.** application intake

Why these answers fit, page 118

F Check accuracy and scope

The proposal has not changed the current application test

Return to the case

The fictional Brookfield Training Grant currently requires 12 months of residence, plus other conditions. Published guidance G4 explains the current requirements. A separate proposal P2 would reduce the residence period to six months, but it has not been adopted and has no effective date. Resident Amina has lived in the area for nine months and brings P2 to the service desk. Program officer Theo must identify the current residence requirement, explain the proposal accurately, and avoid either promising an award or treating this conversation as a formal denial of an application.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What should Theo check before describing a change as operative?

A. Its adoption, applicable terms, and effective date
B. Its publication date and consultation deadline only
C. Whether the application website links to the proposal
D. Whether the proposal has completed its comment period

2. Which statement keeps the processes distinct?

A. Asking about G4 waives the right to apply.
B. Application intake guarantees an award.
C. Commenting on P2 does not itself submit an application for the grant.
D. Every comment automatically becomes an application.

Answers and explanations, page 120

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 9-20, keeping an eligibility explanation separate from a formal decision.

Correct the document, not the person

A resident may reasonably assume that a published document describes the current service. Acknowledge why the documents look confusing, then show their status and identifiers. Explain the current process without implying that asking a question is itself an application or a final decision.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Distinguish another current condition

Guidance H3 states an eight-month residence condition. Proposal Q1 would reduce it to four months but is not adopted. Resident Jo has six months of residence. No formal application decision has been made.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

not adopted / H3 / eight months / not been made

01 **Officer:** The current guidance is [1] _____.

02 **Resident:** The current residence condition is [2] _____.

03 **Officer:** The proposal's status is [3] _____.

04 **Resident:** A formal application decision has [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. H3 / **2.** eight months / **3.** not adopted / **4.** not been made

Why these answers fit, page 120

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The proposal has not changed the current application test". Amina: "If the proposal is adopted later, should I assume it will apply to every application already on file?" Theo: [missing response] Amina: "I would like to support the change. Is submitting a comment the same as asking to receive the grant?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will. The application intake information will explain what to submit and how the review proceeds. Today's explanation neither guarantees an award nor substitutes for that formal process.

B. That is the publication date, not an effective date. No effective date has been established for this proposal. We should not tell applicants that the six-month condition already applies.

C. We would need to read any transition provision in the adopted measure. We cannot invent how pending applications would be handled before the actual terms and dates are available.

D. No. A public comment concerns the proposal. It does not itself submit a grant application. The official notice explains the comment route and the deadline for that process.

Answers and explanations, page 121

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / PUBLIC MEETINGS AND STAKEHOLDER INPUT

Apply an announced participation process consistently while acknowledging disagreement and preserving the public record.

Give the next speaker a fair turn

A fictional town consultation has announced three minutes per speaker, one initial turn each before second turns, and written submissions accepted until Friday at 17:00 local time. Two speakers have already used their initial turns and ask to speak again while five registered speakers remain unheard. Facilitator Rosa and meeting clerk Ian must continue the queue consistently, regardless of whether a speaker supports or opposes the proposal. The meeting gathers input; it is not an up-or-down public vote. Any accessibility request should be handled through the stated meeting arrangements rather than dismissed as an attempt to gain extra influence.

People: Rosa, Meeting facilitator; Ian, Meeting clerk.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Who should be called next under the announced process?

A. Only a speaker supporting the proposal
B. Whoever speaks most loudly
C. The next registered speaker who has not had an initial turn
D. Either repeat speaker before the waiting group

2. What is the written-submission deadline?

A. Friday at 17:00 local time
B. Immediately after each speaker's turn
C. Monday at 09:00
D. An unannounced time chosen after the meeting

3. What is this meeting's purpose?

A. To count applause as a binding ballot
B. To approve every speaker's request
C. To gather input, not decide the proposal by a public vote
D. To award a contract immediately

Answers and explanations, page 122

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

consultation
A process of seeking input before or during decision development.

conduct a consultation

facilitator
A person guiding a discussion and its agreed process.

support the facilitator

agenda
The planned sequence of meeting business.

follow the agenda

speaking allocation
The time or opportunity assigned to a speaker.

explain the speaking allocation

second turn
A later speaking opportunity after an initial contribution.

allow second turns

procedural reminder
A statement recalling the process currently being followed.

give a procedural reminder

stakeholder
A person or group affected by or interested in an issue.

hear from stakeholders

meeting clerk
The person maintaining meeting records and administrative arrangements.

brief the meeting clerk

speaker queue
The ordered list of people waiting to speak.

manage the speaker queue

initial turn
A person's first opportunity to speak in the relevant round.

complete initial turns

time limit
The stated maximum duration of an activity or contribution.

apply the time limit

viewpoint neutrality
Consistent treatment without favoring a position on the issue.

maintain viewpoint neutrality

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

consultation CONSULTATION

conduct a consultation

Keep the meaning precise: A process of seeking input before or during decision development.

speaker queue SPEAKER QUEUE

manage the speaker queue

Keep the meaning precise: The ordered list of people waiting to speak.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

oral submission
Input delivered by speaking.
record an oral submission

written submission
Input provided in written form.
accept written submissions

submission deadline
The final time for receiving input under the process.
state the submission deadline

meeting record
Documentation of the meeting and its relevant proceedings.
maintain the meeting record

attribution
Identification of the source of a statement.
check attribution

summary
A condensed account preserving the relevant meaning.
verify the summary

clarification
An explanation resolving ambiguity in a statement or process.
request clarification

accessibility arrangement
A measure supporting participation by people with access needs.
coordinate accessibility arrangements

interpretation
Spoken or signed language conversion supporting understanding.
arrange interpretation

accommodation request
A request for an adjustment to support access or participation.
handle an accommodation request

deliberation
Structured examination of issues before a decision.
distinguish input from deliberation

decision authority
The person or body empowered to make the relevant decision.
identify the decision authority

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

viewpoint neutrality VIEWPOINT NEUTRALITY

maintain viewpoint neutrality

Keep the meaning precise: Consistent treatment without favoring a position on the issue.

attribution ATTRIBUTION

check attribution

Keep the meaning precise: Identification of the source of a statement.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the contribution

Thank you; your concern has been recorded.

Name the waiting group

Five registered speakers have not yet been heard.

Apply the time limit

The speaking allocation is three minutes.

Avoid a personal rebuke

I am applying the turn-taking process, not judging your position.

Clarify the meeting purpose

This consultation gathers input; it is not a public ballot.

Preserve attribution

Please identify that as the speaker's claim, not a verified finding.

Avoid an invented promise

I cannot guarantee a second turn before the remaining initial speakers.

Close the oral session

The meeting record will preserve the contributions received.

Recall the process

We announced one initial turn each before second turns.

Move the queue

I will now call the next person awaiting an initial turn.

Separate viewpoint

The same process applies to support and opposition.

Offer the stated route

Written submissions remain open until Friday at 17:00 local time.

Check the record

Does that summary accurately capture the point you made?

Handle access needs

Let us use the announced accessibility arrangements for that request.

Explain decision authority

The designated body will make the decision through its stated process.

Restate the next step

We will explain how the input proceeds to the decision stage.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Move the queue
Useful wording: I will now call the next person awaiting an initial turn.

Purpose: Apply the time limit
Useful wording: The speaking allocation is three minutes.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which intervention best follows the process?

A. Thank you; we will hear the remaining initial speakers before returning to second turns.
B. We will let supporters speak twice before opponents speak once.
C. The loudest speaker can choose the queue.
D. All remaining speakers lose their turns because time is tight.

2. Which record entry is appropriately attributed?

A. Every concern is an official finding.
B. A speaker reported concerns about evening access.
C. Evening access is proven inadequate because one speaker said so.
D. The entire community unanimously opposes the proposal.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The person maintaining meeting records and administrative arrangements. Which term fits?

A. interpretation
B. meeting clerk
C. second turn
D. submission deadline

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Give the next speaker a fair turn". Rosa: "One supports the proposal and the other opposes it. We need to make clear that this is not about either position." Ian: [missing response] Rosa: "Could we promise them another opportunity at the end, so they are less frustrated now?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Use a procedural reminder. Thank them, confirm that their points were recorded, and explain that the next registered person who has not spoken will now be called.

B. Keep the attribution. Record that a speaker reported an evening-access concern. We can preserve the point without turning it into a verified finding about every resident.

C. That is viewpoint neutrality. Apply the same initial-turn rule and the same announced three-minute allocation. The explanation should focus on process, not agreement with their arguments.

D. The submission deadline is Friday at 17:00 local time. We should repeat the same time and submission instructions so that people can use that route reliably.

Answers and explanations, page 122

> **One useful distinction**
>
> A consultation can collect evidence, experiences, and arguments without being a referendum. Do not describe applause, speaker counts, or the most forceful contribution as a binding vote when the announced process gives decision authority elsewhere.

E Conversation

Give the next speaker a fair turn

Give the next speaker a fair turn

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

attribution / initial turn / viewpoint neutrality / consultation / submission deadline / second turn / accessibility arrangement / meeting record / procedural reminder / decision authority

01 **Rosa:** Before I reopen the floor, can you check the queue? The two people asking to come back have both spoken, and I can see others still waiting.

02 **Ian:** Five people are waiting for an [1] _____. The two asking to return have already used theirs. We announced that everyone gets that first opportunity before we move to second turns.

03 **Rosa:** I heard their concerns. Now I need to move the meeting on without making it sound as though disagreement costs someone a turn.

04 **Ian:** Use a [2] _____. Thank them, confirm that their points were recorded, and explain that the next registered person who has not spoken will now be called.

05 **Rosa:** One supports the proposal and the other opposes it. We need to make clear that this is not about either position.

06 **Ian:** That is [3] _____. Apply the same initial-turn rule and the same announced three-minute allocation. The explanation should focus on process, not agreement with their arguments.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Rosa:** Could we promise them another opportunity at the end, so they are less frustrated now?

08 **Ian:** We can explain the possibility of a [4] _____, but not guarantee it before the remaining initial speakers. We also have the written-submission route that was announced at the start.

09 **Rosa:** Please remind me of the exact deadline. I do not want to give two different times in the same meeting.

10 **Ian:** The [5] _____ is Friday at 17:00 local time. We should repeat the same time and submission instructions so that people can use that route reliably.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Give the next speaker a fair turn

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Rosa:** One resident asked whether the amount of applause will determine the result. We should correct that before the next speaker.

12 **Ian:** Yes. This [6] _____ gathers input. It is not an up-or-down vote, and applause does not replace the designated decision process or establish what everyone in the town thinks.

13 **Rosa:** The clerk's summary says that residents cannot reach the site in the evening. Only one person has made that claim so far.

14 **Ian:** Keep the [7] _____. Record that a speaker reported an evening-access concern. We can preserve the point without turning it into a verified finding about every resident.

15 **Rosa:** Another participant has asked for an adjustment so they can follow and contribute to the discussion. How should I respond?

16 **Ian:** Use the announced [8] _____ process. Do not treat the request as an attempt to gain influence. Check the appropriate adjustment and communicate it clearly without disclosing unnecessary personal details.

17 **Rosa:** I will call the next initial speaker, restate the allocation, and explain that the written route remains available.

18 **Ian:** I will update the [9] _____ and check that summaries retain their meaning. Recording a concern does not mean the office endorses it, but it should not be lost.

19 **Rosa:** Before closing, we also need to say who makes the decision and where people can find the next-stage information.

20 **Ian:** Agreed. Name the [10] _____ and the stated next steps. That gives participants a useful account of how their input moves forward without promising that every requested change will be adopted.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. initial turn / **2.** procedural reminder / **3.** viewpoint neutrality / **4.** second turn / **5.** submission deadline / **6.** consultation / **7.** attribution / **8.** accessibility arrangement / **9.** meeting record / **10.** decision authority

Why these answers fit, page 123

F Check accuracy and scope

Give the next speaker a fair turn

Return to the case

A fictional town consultation has announced three minutes per speaker, one initial turn each before second turns, and written submissions accepted until Friday at 17:00 local time. Two speakers have already used their initial turns and ask to speak again while five registered speakers remain unheard. Facilitator Rosa and meeting clerk Ian must continue the queue consistently, regardless of whether a speaker supports or opposes the proposal. The meeting gathers input; it is not an up-or-down public vote. Any accessibility request should be handled through the stated meeting arrangements rather than dismissed as an attempt to gain extra influence.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. How should an access request be handled?

A. By counting the request as the person's initial contribution
B. By postponing all access arrangements until written consultation
C. Through the announced accessibility arrangements
D. By applying an identical format without checking an adjustment

2. Which explanation correctly describes the meeting?

A. Applause determines the binding result.
B. The two longest speakers decide the outcome.
C. Every written submission guarantees adoption of its request.
D. It gathers input for the designated decision process.

Answers and explanations, page 125

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20; stress the difference between a reported concern and an official finding.

Be firm about process and neutral about viewpoint

A public disagreement may be strongly expressed without justifying unequal access to the microphone. Refer to the announced turn-taking process, acknowledge the contribution, and explain the next opportunity. Keep procedural decisions separate from agreement with the speaker.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Apply another meeting process

A meeting allows two minutes per initial speaker before repeat turns. Three registered people remain unheard. Written input closes Wednesday at 12:00 local time. The session is consultation, not a ballot.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

two minutes / Wednesday at 12:00 local time / consultation / three

01 **Chair:** The initial speaking allocation is [1] _____.

02 **Clerk:** The number of registered people still unheard is [2] _____.

03 **Chair:** Written input closes [3] _____.

04 **Clerk:** The session is a [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. two minutes / **2.** three / **3.** Wednesday at 12:00 local time / **4.** consultation

Why these answers fit, page 125

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Give the next speaker a fair turn". Rosa: "The clerk's summary says that residents cannot reach the site in the evening. Only one person has made that claim so far." Ian: [missing response] Rosa: "Another participant has asked for an adjustment so they can follow and contribute to the discussion. How should I respond?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Use a procedural reminder. Thank them, confirm that their points were recorded, and explain that the next registered person who has not spoken will now be called.

B. Keep the attribution. Record that a speaker reported an evening-access concern. We can preserve the point without turning it into a verified finding about every resident.

C. The submission deadline is Friday at 17:00 local time. We should repeat the same time and submission instructions so that people can use that route reliably.

D. That is viewpoint neutrality. Apply the same initial-turn rule and the same announced three-minute allocation. The explanation should focus on process, not agreement with their arguments.

Answers and explanations, page 126

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Policy Implementation and Program Rules" and "Public Meetings and Stakeholder Input". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Published explanatory material reflecting the presently applicable position. Which term fits?

A. implementation date

B. public comment

C. supporting evidence

D. current guidance

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A person's first opportunity to speak in the relevant round. Which term fits?

A. oral submission

B. initial turn

C. consultation

D. clarification

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The proposal has not changed the current application test". Amina: "I do not want a question at the desk to be recorded as a final rejection. I am trying to understand the process." Theo: [missing response] Amina: "Are there other conditions beyond residence? The proposal headline makes the program sound much simpler." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I understand the confusion. The current guidance still describes a twelve-month residence requirement. P2 would reduce that to six months, but the proposal has not been adopted.

B. This is not an eligibility determination. I can show you the actual application and review steps, including where to obtain case-specific information within the program's process.

C. Let us check the proposal you are holding. This is P2, which suggests a change. G4 is the guidance describing the requirements that currently apply.

D. Exactly. Check the adoption status before treating a change as operative. Until then, use G4 for the current program explanation and P2 for the suggested change.

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Give the next speaker a fair turn". Rosa: "I will call the next initial speaker, restate the allocation, and explain that the written route remains available." Ian: [missing response] Rosa: "Before closing, we also need to say who makes the decision and where people can find the next-stage information." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. We can explain the possibility of a second turn, but not guarantee it before the remaining initial speakers. We also have the written-submission route that was announced at the start.

B. Yes. This consultation gathers input. It is not an up-or-down vote, and applause does not replace the designated decision process or establish what everyone in the town thinks.

C. Use the announced accessibility arrangement process. Do not treat the request as an attempt to gain influence. Check the appropriate adjustment and communicate it clearly without disclosing unnecessary personal details.

D. I will update the meeting record and check that summaries retain their meaning. Recording a concern does not mean the office endorses it, but it should not be lost.

Answers and explanations, page 157

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / PROCUREMENT AND VENDOR SELECTION

Connect a procurement recommendation to published criteria, comparable evidence, and an authorized decision process.

> **Best value needs a reason, not just a label**
>
> A fictional office evaluates two service proposals using published maximum scores: technical approach 50, service delivery 30, and price 20. Recorded weighted scores are A: 45, 25, 16, total 86; B: 40, 24, 18, total 82. A costs $120,000 and B costs $110,000. The method permits a documented trade-off, but the draft note only says A is best value. Evaluator Dev and procurement officer Marta must explain the scored differences and the $10,000 premium. A vendor's local address is not a published criterion. The award has not been authorized.

People: Dev, Technical evaluator; Marta, Procurement officer.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What are the recorded totals?

A. A has 86 and B has 82.
B. A has 82 and B has 86.
C. Both have 90.
D. A has 45 and B has 40 overall.

2. What is A's price premium?

A. $30,000
B. $10,000
C. $4,000
D. $16,000

3. Which consideration is not a published criterion?

A. The vendor's local address
B. Technical approach
C. Service delivery
D. Price

Answers and explanations, page 127

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

procurement
The process of obtaining goods or services under applicable rules.

manage procurement

solicitation
A formal request inviting offers under stated requirements.

review the solicitation

offeror
A supplier submitting an offer in response to a solicitation.

evaluate the offeror

evaluation factor
A stated dimension used to assess proposals.

apply the evaluation factors

subfactor
A defined component of a broader evaluation factor.

assess the subfactor

relative importance
The stated relationship in significance among evaluation factors.

state relative importance

weighted score
A score already adjusted to reflect the specified scoring importance.

verify the weighted scores

scoring matrix
A structured record of scores against criteria.

reconcile the scoring matrix

technical approach
The proposed method for delivering the required work.

evaluate the technical approach

service-delivery plan
The proposed arrangement for providing the required service.

assess the service-delivery plan

price premium
The amount by which one price exceeds another.

justify the price premium

best value
The most advantageous result under the applicable selection method.

explain the best-value judgment

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

procurement PROCUREMENT

manage procurement

Keep the meaning precise: The process of obtaining goods or services under applicable rules.

relative importance RELATIVE IMPORTANCE

state relative importance

Keep the meaning precise: The stated relationship in significance among evaluation factors.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

trade-off

A comparison accepting one disadvantage for a supported benefit.

document the trade-off

strength

An assessed favorable feature under an evaluation criterion.

substantiate a strength

weakness

An assessed unfavorable feature under an evaluation criterion.

document a weakness

deficiency

A material failure to meet a stated requirement under the applicable method.

identify a deficiency

past performance

Evidence of how a supplier performed on relevant previous work.

assess past performance

evaluation narrative

Written reasoning supporting the recorded assessment.

complete the evaluation narrative

source selection

The process of choosing a supplier under the applicable procedure.

support source selection

award authority

The person or body empowered to authorize the contract award.

confirm award authority

conflict of interest

An interest that may improperly influence, or appear to influence, official judgment.

disclose a conflict of interest

recusal

Withdrawal from a matter under the applicable conflict-handling process.

arrange recusal

audit trail

Records allowing a decision or transaction to be traced.

preserve the audit trail

debriefing

A structured explanation of a procurement outcome under applicable procedures.

prepare a debriefing

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

best value BEST VALUE

explain the best-value judgment

Keep the meaning precise: The most advantageous result under the applicable selection method.

past performance PAST PERFORMANCE

assess past performance

Keep the meaning precise: Evidence of how a supplier performed on relevant previous work.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Ask for the rationale

What does best value mean under this selection method?

Return to the criteria

Let us use the published evaluation factors.

Check the arithmetic

The weighted scores total eighty-six for A and eighty-two for B.

Avoid double weighting

These scores have already been weighted.

Name the price difference

A carries a ten-thousand-dollar premium.

Identify the strength

Which submitted feature supports the technical advantage?

Link evidence to judgment

Cite the proposal evidence beside the relevant criterion.

Explain the trade-off

The note must explain why the assessed benefit justifies the premium.

Reject an added preference

Local address is not a published criterion.

Preserve equal treatment

Apply the same evidence standard to both offers.

Clarify the status

This is an evaluation recommendation, not an award.

Check authority

The designated award authority still needs to decide.

Handle a conflict

Any relevant interest should go through the conflict-review process.

Avoid score-only reasoning

The total does not replace the evaluation narrative.

Keep the record reviewable

A reader should be able to trace each conclusion to its evidence.

Close the revision

Revise the rationale without changing the published method.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Avoid double weighting
Useful wording: These scores have already been weighted.

Purpose: Name the price difference
Useful wording: A carries a ten-thousand-dollar premium.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which evaluation note is strongest?

A. Add local address as a deciding factor after scoring.

B. Ignore price because A has the higher total.

C. Link A's scored strengths to proposal evidence and explain the $10,000 premium.

D. State best value without further detail.

2. What should happen to the existing weighted scores?

A. Multiply each one by its factor maximum again.

B. Replace the price scores with the dollar figures.

C. Average only the two highest factors.

D. Check their arithmetic without applying the weights again.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A stated dimension used to assess proposals. Which term fits?

A. weakness

B. conflict of interest

C. technical approach

D. evaluation factor

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Best value needs a reason, not just a label". Marta: "A is also ten thousand dollars more expensive. The note cannot simply report the higher total and leave that difference unexplained." Dev: [missing response] Marta: "Which features support the technical difference? A reader should not have to infer a benefit from the score alone." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No. It is not an evaluation factor, so we should not add it now. The published dimensions are technical approach, service delivery, and price, with the stated relative importance.

B. I will preserve that audit trail. The revision will explain the recommendation under the existing method, not introduce a new preference to make the result easier to defend.

C. Agreed. The price premium is part of the decision. A costs one hundred twenty thousand, while B costs one hundred ten thousand. Our method permits a documented trade-off.

D. No, each weighted score is final for that factor. We should check the addition, but applying the weights again would change the evaluation rather than verify it.

Answers and explanations, page 127

One useful distinction

The scores are already weighted. Do not apply the 50/30/20 maxima a second time. The totals are 86 and 82. A higher score is relevant under this method, but the permitted trade-off still needs a reasoned record of the benefits and premium.

E Conversation

Best value needs a reason, not just a label

Best value needs a reason, not just a label

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

scoring matrix / trade-off / audit trail / evaluation narrative / weighted score / award authority / conflict of interest / evaluation factor / Best value / price premium

01 **Marta:** I can check the totals, but I cannot sign this rationale yet. Best value is doing a lot of work in the draft. Show me what sits behind it.

02 **Dev:** The [1] _____ gives A forty-five for technical approach, twenty-five for service delivery, and sixteen for price. B has forty, twenty-four, and eighteen respectively.

03 **Marta:** That gives eighty-six and eighty-two. Are those raw marks that still need the fifty, thirty, and twenty weighting applied?

04 **Dev:** No, each [2] _____ is final for that factor. We should check the addition, but applying the weights again would change the evaluation rather than verify it.

05 **Marta:** A is also ten thousand dollars more expensive. The note cannot simply report the higher total and leave that difference unexplained.

06 **Dev:** Agreed. The [3] _____ is part of the decision. A costs one hundred twenty thousand, while B costs one hundred ten thousand. Our method permits a documented trade-off.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Marta:** Which features support the technical difference? A reader should not have to infer a benefit from the score alone.

08 **Dev:** I need to expand the [4] _____. Each assessed strength should point to the submitted material and the technical factor it addresses, rather than a general impression that A seems better.

09 **Marta:** Someone suggested mentioning that A's office is local. Does the solicitation give us a factor for that?

10 **Dev:** No. It is not an [5] _____, so we should not add it now. The published dimensions are technical approach, service delivery, and price, with the stated relative importance.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Best value needs a reason, not just a label

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Marta:** We also need to show that B's stronger price result was recognized, not quietly removed because the team prefers A.

12 **Dev:** The [6] _____ explanation should do that. It must explain why the evidenced benefits of A are judged worth the premium, if that remains the supported recommendation.

13 **Marta:** Is a four-point lead sufficient by itself? The summary says highest score therefore award, which skips the trade-off we have just discussed.

14 **Dev:** No. [7] _____ depends on this selection method and a defensible record. We should not present our scoring example as a rule for every procurement.

15 **Marta:** Before circulation, check that any interests affecting an evaluator have gone through the proper disclosure process.

16 **Dev:** I will confirm the [8] _____ review status. That belongs in the appropriate record, without turning an unsupported suspicion about a colleague into an allegation in the evaluation note.

17 **Marta:** Once the explanation is complete, who actually authorizes the contract award? The draft sounds as though the evaluation team already has.

18 **Dev:** The designated [9] _____ still needs to decide. I will label the document as our recommendation and remove wording that suggests an award has already been made.

19 **Marta:** Good. Keep the published criteria, the verified totals, the evidence, and the premium visible in the revised note.

20 **Dev:** I will preserve that [10] _____. The revision will explain the recommendation under the existing method, not introduce a new preference to make the result easier to defend.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. scoring matrix / **2.** weighted score / **3.** price premium / **4.** evaluation narrative / **5.** evaluation factor / **6.** trade-off / **7.** Best value / **8.** conflict of interest / **9.** award authority / **10.** audit trail

Why these answers fit, page 128

F Check accuracy and scope

Best value needs a reason, not just a label

Return to the case

A fictional office evaluates two service proposals using published maximum scores: technical approach 50, service delivery 30, and price 20. Recorded weighted scores are A: 45, 25, 16, total 86; B: 40, 24, 18, total 82. A costs $120,000 and B costs $110,000. The method permits a documented trade-off, but the draft note only says A is best value. Evaluator Dev and procurement officer Marta must explain the scored differences and the $10,000 premium. A vendor's local address is not a published criterion. The award has not been authorized.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which statement preserves authority?

A. The evaluation recommends A; the award decision remains pending.
B. The evaluator's preference alone executes the contract.
C. A's local address automatically authorizes the award.
D. A four-point lead removes every approval requirement.

2. Which challenge is appropriate?

A. Can we replace the method with a personal impression?
B. Which published factor and submitted evidence support that claimed strength?
C. Can we add a factor that favors the supplier we prefer?
D. Should we remove B's stronger price score?

Answers and explanations, page 130

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 9-20, stressing published factors and recommendation rather than award.

Challenge the rationale without reopening the rules

A request to explain an evaluation is not necessarily an accusation of bias. Link the judgment to the announced criteria and the submitted evidence. Do not quietly introduce a new preference after seeing which supplier it would favor.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Explain another scored comparison

Under a stated trade-off method, C has already-weighted scores of 42, 26, and 17. D has 40, 25, and 19. C costs $75,000 and D $70,000. Award approval is pending.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

approval pending / $5,000 / 85 / 84

01 **Evaluator:** C's total weighted score is [1] _____.

02 **Officer:** D's total weighted score is [2] _____.

03 **Evaluator:** C's price premium is [3] _____.

04 **Officer:** The award status is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 85 / **2.** 84 / **3.** $5,000 / **4.** approval pending

Why these answers fit, page 130

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Best value needs a reason, not just a label". Marta: "Is a four-point lead sufficient by itself? The summary says highest score therefore award, which skips the trade-off we have just discussed." Dev: [missing response] Marta: "Before circulation, check that any interests affecting an evaluator have gone through the proper disclosure process." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The scoring matrix gives A forty-five for technical approach, twenty-five for service delivery, and sixteen for price. B has forty, twenty-four, and eighteen respectively.

B. No. Best value depends on this selection method and a defensible record. We should not present our scoring example as a rule for every procurement.

C. No, each weighted score is final for that factor. We should check the addition, but applying the weights again would change the evaluation rather than verify it.

D. The trade-off explanation should do that. It must explain why the evidenced benefits of A are judged worth the premium, if that remains the supported recommendation.

Answers and explanations, page 131

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / GRANTS, COMPLIANCE, AND REPORTING

Reconcile expenditure categories to supporting records and explain an unresolved difference without inventing a balancing entry.

> **The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence**
>
> Grant G62 reports $48,000 spent in the quarter: personnel $30,000, materials $12,000, and travel $6,000. The reporting instructions request these categories and supporting records. The currently assembled records support personnel $29,000, materials $12,000, and travel $6,000, totaling $47,000. One $1,000 personnel item lacks the requested supporting record. Grant officer Sana and finance coordinator Owen must flag the evidence gap, seek the missing record, and follow the actual correction and submission process. The difference alone does not establish fraud, allowability, or authority to move the amount into another category.

People: Sana, Grant officer; Owen, Finance coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What total do the assembled supporting records substantiate?

A. $30,000
B. $47,000
C. $48,000
D. $46,000

2. Where is the evidence gap?

A. A $1,000 personnel item
B. All travel costs
C. A $12,000 materials item
D. An unexplained $6,000 surplus

3. What conclusion is not established by the difference alone?

A. A difference between reported and supported totals
B. Fraud or cost allowability
C. A need to reconcile the report
D. A personnel documentation gap

Answers and explanations, page 132

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

grant award
Funding provided under specified terms for an approved purpose.

identify the grant award

recipient
The entity receiving an award directly from the awarding body.

identify the recipient

subrecipient
An entity carrying out part of an award under a subaward.

monitor the subrecipient

pass-through entity
An entity providing a subaward from funding it has received.

contact the pass-through entity

award terms
The conditions governing a particular funding award.

review the award terms

reporting period
The time interval covered by a report.

confirm the reporting period

expenditure
An amount spent or recognized as spent under the applicable basis.

report expenditures

budget category
A defined grouping of planned or reported costs.

reconcile budget categories

personnel cost
Cost associated with staff work under the applicable accounting rules.

document personnel costs

source documentation
Original or supporting records substantiating a transaction.

obtain source documentation

supporting schedule
A detailed breakdown supporting a reported figure.

prepare a supporting schedule

general ledger
The main accounting record organizing transactions by account.

reconcile the general ledger

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

grant award GRANT AWARD

identify the grant award

Keep the meaning precise: Funding provided under specified terms for an approved purpose.

reporting period REPORTING PERIOD

confirm the reporting period

Keep the meaning precise: The time interval covered by a report.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

reconciliation

Comparison of records to identify and explain differences.

complete the reconciliation

unsupported item

An item lacking the evidence required for the stated review.

flag an unsupported item

allocable cost

A cost assignable to an activity under the applicable benefit relationship.

assess cost allocability

indirect cost

A cost supporting multiple activities rather than one readily identified objective.

review indirect costs

unobligated balance

Funds not committed through obligations under the applicable accounting basis.

report the unobligated balance

corrected report

A revised submission fixing identified reporting errors.

submit a corrected report

variance

A difference between compared figures or positions.

explain the variance

allowable cost

A cost permitted under the applicable rules and award terms.

assess cost allowability

cost share

The portion of project costs met from sources specified outside the award funding.

document cost share

obligation

A commitment creating a requirement to pay under the applicable definition.

distinguish obligations from expenditures

certification

An authorized attestation about specified information or compliance.

review the certification

closeout

The process of completing award-end administrative and financial requirements.

prepare for closeout

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

general ledger GENERAL LEDGER

reconcile the general ledger

Keep the meaning precise: The main accounting record organizing transactions by account.

allocable cost ALLOCABLE COST

assess cost allocability

Keep the meaning precise: A cost assignable to an activity under the applicable benefit relationship.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Identify the award
We are reconciling the quarterly report for G62.

State the reported total
The report shows forty-eight thousand dollars.

State the supported total
The assembled records support forty-seven thousand dollars.

Locate the difference
The one-thousand-dollar gap is in personnel.

Separate arithmetic from evidence
The categories add correctly, but the supporting record is incomplete.

Request the missing record
Please locate the record for that specific personnel item.

Avoid an accusation
The gap does not by itself establish fraud.

Preserve the classification
Do not move the amount into travel just to balance the report.

Check the reporting basis
Are these figures for the same award, period, and accounting basis?

Qualify allowability
Supporting documentation does not alone settle cost allowability.

Keep the gap visible
Mark the item as unresolved in the reconciliation.

Ask about correction
What does the applicable process require before submission?

Avoid false certification
We should not certify completeness while this required support is missing.

Assign the follow-up
Owen will trace the item and return the evidence status.

Retain the record
Keep the original figures and any authorized correction traceable.

Close the review
The final report should match the approved treatment and supporting records.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Locate the difference
Useful wording: The one-thousand-dollar gap is in personnel.

Purpose: Separate arithmetic from evidence
Useful wording: The categories add correctly, but the supporting record is incomplete.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which reconciliation statement is correct?

A. Both reported and supported expenditure are $48,000.

B. Travel is short by $1,000.

C. The report has a $1,000 addition error.

D. Reported expenditure is $48,000; assembled support is $47,000, with $1,000 unresolved in personnel.

2. What should Owen do first with the specific gap?

A. Trace the personnel item and seek the missing support.

B. Add $1,000 to travel without evidence.

C. Delete the item silently from every record.

D. Declare fraud before investigating.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An entity providing a subaward from funding it has received. Which term fits?

A. unsupported item

B. unobligated balance

C. pass-through entity

D. personnel cost

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence". Sana: "Then the issue is not that the spreadsheet added the categories incorrectly. It is that the evidence does not yet support every reported item." Owen: [missing response] Sana: "Someone suggested moving the thousand into travel because that category has room in the budget. That would make the report look less awkward." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. We are missing source documentation for one thousand dollars in that category. I need to trace the specific item rather than assume it belongs in the folder.

B. I will check the reporting period and the award reference. We should not reconcile a current-quarter total against a folder containing a different period and then explain the wrong discrepancy.

C. Correct. The reconciliation should show forty-eight thousand reported, forty-seven thousand supported, and one thousand unresolved in personnel. That is the clearest description of the current position.

D. The supporting schedule shows thirty thousand for personnel, twelve thousand for materials, and six thousand for travel. Those figures add correctly to the reported total.

Answers and explanations, page 132

One useful distinction

A reported total can add correctly while its supporting evidence remains incomplete. Here the category figures total $48,000, but the assembled support totals $47,000. The discrepancy is specifically a $1,000 personnel item, not a general arithmetic error.

E Conversation

The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence

The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

budget category / certification / reporting period / reconciliation / variance / Allowable cost / source documentation / corrected report / unsupported item / supporting schedule

01 **Sana:** I cannot tie G62 to the evidence folder. The report says forty-eight thousand; I can support forty-seven. Can we work through the category totals together?

02 **Owen:** The [1] _____ shows thirty thousand for personnel, twelve thousand for materials, and six thousand for travel. Those figures add correctly to the reported total.

03 **Sana:** The records I have show twenty-nine thousand for personnel. Materials and travel match the schedule. Is there another personnel record somewhere?

04 **Owen:** We are missing [2] _____ for one thousand dollars in that category. I need to trace the specific item rather than assume it belongs in the folder.

05 **Sana:** Then the issue is not that the spreadsheet added the categories incorrectly. It is that the evidence does not yet support every reported item.

06 **Owen:** Correct. The [3] _____ should show forty-eight thousand reported, forty-seven thousand supported, and one thousand unresolved in personnel. That is the clearest description of the current position.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Sana:** Someone suggested moving the thousand into travel because that category has room in the budget. That would make the report look less awkward.

08 **Owen:** Available budget does not determine the [4] _____ of an actual transaction. We should not reclassify the item simply to remove the visible gap. The treatment needs evidence and the proper review.

09 **Sana:** The draft issue note calls it fraud. All we know so far is that the record is missing. I want the wording to reflect that distinction.

10 **Owen:** Call it an [5] _____ at this stage. Missing support does not by itself establish intent. We can state exactly what is absent and what we are doing to obtain it.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Sana:** If you find the record, does that automatically settle whether the grant can pay for the cost?

12 **Owen:** No. [6] _____ status depends on the applicable rules and award terms as well. The record supports the transaction; the reviewer still needs the relevant basis for charging it to the award.

13 **Sana:** Before comparing the figures again, please confirm that we are using the same quarter and the same accounting basis.

14 **Owen:** I will check the [7] _____ and the award reference. We should not reconcile a current-quarter total against a folder containing a different period and then explain the wrong discrepancy.

15 **Sana:** The submission includes a completeness certification. I do not want us to sign it while ignoring a required missing record.

16 **Owen:** We should flag that before [8] _____. I will return the evidence status and ask what the actual correction and submission process requires, rather than choosing a treatment on my own.

17 **Sana:** If a correction is authorized, keep the original report and the reason for the change. We need a clear history.

18 **Owen:** Agreed. A [9] _____ should be traceable to the review decision. Quietly replacing the number would make it harder to understand what happened and whether the issue was actually resolved.

The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence / continued

19 **Sana:** Please send the specific item reference, the missing evidence, and your follow-up status to me before we finalize the submission.

20 **Owen:** I will keep the [10] _____ visible until it is resolved through that process. We can be precise about the gap without either hiding it or claiming more than the evidence shows.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. supporting schedule / **2.** source documentation / **3.** reconciliation / **4.** budget category / **5.** unsupported item / **6.** Allowable cost / **7.** reporting period / **8.** certification / **9.** corrected report / **10.** variance

Why these answers fit, page 134

F Check accuracy and scope

The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence

Return to the case

Grant G62 reports $48,000 spent in the quarter: personnel $30,000, materials $12,000, and travel $6,000. The reporting instructions request these categories and supporting records. The currently assembled records support personnel $29,000, materials $12,000, and travel $6,000, totaling $47,000. One $1,000 personnel item lacks the requested supporting record. Grant officer Sana and finance coordinator Owen must flag the evidence gap, seek the missing record, and follow the actual correction and submission process. The difference alone does not establish fraud, allowability, or authority to move the amount into another category.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which statement about allowability is sound?

A. A balanced spreadsheet alone establishes allowability.
B. It requires review under the applicable rules and award terms.
C. Every ledger entry is automatically allowable.
D. Missing support proves the cost is forbidden in every program.

2. What should a correction preserve?

A. A different category chosen to hide the gap
B. An unsupported completeness certification
C. A traceable record of the original figure, reason, approval, and revised treatment
D. Only the final number with no explanation

Answers and explanations, page 135

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 9-20; keep the unresolved item neutral and specific.

Use neutral discrepancy language

A missing record may lead to several possible explanations. State the amount, category, and evidence gap without accusing a colleague or making the problem disappear. A clear reconciliation lets the responsible reviewer decide what needs correction or further support.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Reconcile another grant total

Grant K9 reports personnel $18,000, materials $7,000, and travel $3,000. Assembled support is $18,000, $6,500, and $3,000 respectively. One materials record remains missing.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

$500 / $27,500 / materials / $28,000

01 **Officer:** The reported total is [1] _____.

02 **Coordinator:** The supported total is [2] _____.

03 **Officer:** The unresolved difference is [3] _____.

04 **Coordinator:** The affected category is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. $28,000 / **2.** $27,500 / **3.** $500 / **4.** materials

Why these answers fit, page 135

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence". Sana: "Before comparing the figures again, please confirm that we are using the same quarter and the same accounting basis." Owen: [missing response] Sana: "The submission includes a completeness certification. I do not want us to sign it while ignoring a required missing record." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will check the reporting period and the award reference. We should not reconcile a current-quarter total against a folder containing a different period and then explain the wrong discrepancy.

B. Agreed. A corrected report should be traceable to the review decision. Quietly replacing the number would make it harder to understand what happened and whether the issue was actually resolved.

C. We should flag that before certification. I will return the evidence status and ask what the actual correction and submission process requires, rather than choosing a treatment on my own.

D. Call it an unsupported item at this stage. Missing support does not by itself establish intent. We can state exactly what is absent and what we are doing to obtain it.

Answers and explanations, page 136

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Procurement and Vendor Selection" and "Grants, Compliance, and Reporting". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A supplier submitting an offer in response to a solicitation. Which term fits?

A. award authority
B. scoring matrix
C. strength
D. offeror

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A defined grouping of planned or reported costs. Which term fits?

A. budget category
B. grant award
C. reconciliation
D. indirect cost

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Give the next speaker a fair turn". Rosa: "Please remind me of the exact deadline. I do not want to give two different times in the same meeting." Ian: [missing response] Rosa: "One resident asked whether the amount of applause will determine the result. We should correct that before the next speaker." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep the attribution. Record that a speaker reported an evening-access concern. We can preserve the point without turning it into a verified finding about every resident.
B. The submission deadline is Friday at 17:00 local time. We should repeat the same time and submission instructions so that people can use that route reliably.
C. That is viewpoint neutrality. Apply the same initial-turn rule and the same announced three-minute allocation. The explanation should focus on process, not agreement with their arguments.
D. Use a procedural reminder. Thank them, confirm that their points were recorded, and explain that the next registered person who has not spoken will now be called.

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence". Sana: "If a correction is authorized, keep the original report and the reason for the change. We need a clear history." Owen: [missing response] Sana: "Please send the specific item reference, the missing evidence, and your follow-up status to me before we finalize the submission." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. We should flag that before certification. I will return the evidence status and ask what the actual correction and submission process requires, rather than choosing a treatment on my own.

B. Agreed. A corrected report should be traceable to the review decision. Quietly replacing the number would make it harder to understand what happened and whether the issue was actually resolved.

C. Call it an unsupported item at this stage. Missing support does not by itself establish intent. We can state exactly what is absent and what we are doing to obtain it.

D. I will check the reporting period and the award reference. We should not reconcile a current-quarter total against a folder containing a different period and then explain the wrong discrepancy.

Answers and explanations, page 159

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / INTERAGENCY COORDINATION

Assign distinct responsibilities across agencies and confirm a handoff without implying that the underlying service is approved.

> **Everyone is involved, but nobody has called the resident**
>
> Request Q41 concerns accessible transport to a community appointment. The Community Office reviews program eligibility; the Transit Office checks vehicle availability and booking feasibility. Each office assumed the other would contact the resident. During a coordination call, Jon from Community agrees to own the resident update at 15:00 local time. Aisha from Transit will send an availability status to Jon by 14:30. Eligibility and a booking both remain unconfirmed. The authorized initial handoff needs the request reference, pickup zone, and requested time window, not the resident's full medical file.

People: Jon, Community Office coordinator; Aisha, Transit Office coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Who owns the resident update?

A. The resident's appointment provider
B. Jon at 15:00 local time
C. Aisha at an unspecified time
D. Both offices without a named lead

2. What will Transit provide by 14:30?

A. A guaranteed completed trip
B. A Community eligibility decision
C. The resident's full medical file
D. An availability status to Jon

3. What remains unconfirmed?

A. Eligibility and the transport booking
B. The Q41 reference
C. The named resident-contact owner
D. The agreed internal update time

Answers and explanations, page 137

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

interagency
Involving two or more public agencies.

coordinate interagency work

lead contact
The named person coordinating communication for a matter.

appoint a lead contact

referring office
The office sending a matter to another responsible team.

identify the referring office

receiving office
The office to which a matter is transferred.

confirm the receiving office

responsibility matrix
A record mapping tasks to their responsible owners.

update the responsibility matrix

action owner
The named person accountable for a specific next action.

assign an action owner

handoff
Transfer of a task, information, or responsibility between teams.

confirm the handoff

acknowledgment of receipt
Confirmation that information has arrived.

request acknowledgment of receipt

acceptance of responsibility
Confirmation that a person or team has taken ownership of a task.

record acceptance of responsibility

service dependency
A prerequisite affecting whether a service can proceed.

identify service dependencies

availability check
A review of whether the needed resource or slot can be supplied.

complete an availability check

booking confirmation
Notice that a specific service arrangement is reserved or agreed.

issue booking confirmation

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

interagency INTERAGENCY

coordinate interagency work

Keep the meaning precise: Involving two or more public agencies.

action owner ACTION OWNER

assign an action owner

Keep the meaning precise: The named person accountable for a specific next action.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

eligibility review

Assessment against the program's qualification requirements.

complete the eligibility review

pickup zone

The defined area from which a transport pickup is requested.

confirm the pickup zone

data-sharing authority

The applicable basis permitting a defined information transfer.

verify data-sharing authority

purpose limitation

Restricting information use to the defined permitted purpose.

observe purpose limitation

joint status

A coordinated account of progress across participating teams.

prepare a joint status

dependency tracker

A record of prerequisites, owners, and their status.

maintain the dependency tracker

request reference

An identifier linking records to the same service request.

quote the request reference

requested window

The time period asked for before scheduling is confirmed.

record the requested window

minimum necessary data

Information limited to what is needed for the stated authorized purpose.

share the minimum necessary data

secure channel

An approved communication route with appropriate safeguards.

use the secure channel

escalation contact

The person designated for unresolved or urgent coordination issues.

identify the escalation contact

closed-loop handoff

A transfer in which receipt and next responsibility are confirmed.

complete a closed-loop handoff

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

booking confirmation BOOKING CONFIRMATION

issue booking confirmation

Keep the meaning precise: Notice that a specific service arrangement is reserved or agreed.

data-sharing authority DATA-SHARING AUTHORITY

verify data-sharing authority

Keep the meaning precise: The applicable basis permitting a defined information transfer.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Name the gap

Each office assumed the other would contact the resident.

Assign the lead

Jon will own the resident update.

Set the external time

The resident update is at 15:00 local time.

Set the internal time

Transit will send its status to Jon by 14:30.

Define the task

We are checking availability, not confirming a booking yet.

Keep the eligibility boundary

Community retains the eligibility review.

Separate receipt from ownership

Has the receiving office accepted the task, or only received the message?

Use the reference

Please quote Q41 in both records.

Limit the transfer

The initial handoff needs the pickup zone and requested window.

Avoid excess information

The full medical file is not needed for this exchange.

Check permission and method

Use the authorized data-sharing route and approved channel.

Confirm the recipient

Send the availability status to Jon, not directly to an unassigned inbox.

Handle an incomplete result

Report the open question even if availability is not confirmed by then.

Name escalation

Who should we contact if the internal update is missed?

Read back ownership

Aisha checks availability; Jon updates the resident.

Close the loop

Please confirm receipt and the next action in the request record.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Set the internal time
Useful wording: Transit will send its status to Jon by 14:30.

Purpose: Define the task
Useful wording: We are checking availability, not confirming a booking yet.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which handoff is complete?

A. Sending an email alone proves the resident has a booking.

B. Jon transfers every responsibility without acceptance.

C. Aisha sends the availability status by 14:30; Jon confirms receipt and updates the resident at 15:00.

D. Both offices assume someone else will call.

2. Which statement preserves the agencies' roles?

A. Transit automatically decides Community eligibility.

B. Community guarantees a vehicle without asking Transit.

C. Both reviews are complete because the request has a number.

D. Community reviews eligibility; Transit checks availability.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The office to which a matter is transferred. Which term fits?

A. joint status

B. receiving office

C. pickup zone

D. acceptance of responsibility

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Everyone is involved, but nobody has called the resident". Jon: "Is that a booking confirmation, or simply the result of the availability check at that point?" Aisha: [missing response] Jon: "Community still needs to complete its program review. I do not want either team to imply that the transport request itself establishes eligibility." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Agreed. The joint status can explain the open questions. You should be able to give the resident the promised update even if the booking decision is still pending.

B. It is an availability check status. We have not confirmed a vehicle or a booking. I will distinguish available, unavailable, and still under review rather than use the vague word arranged.

C. An acknowledgment of receipt alone would not show ownership. I will record the next action and its deadline so your team can see what I have actually agreed to do.

D. Correct. That is a closed-loop handoff. I will confirm the transfer in Q41 and keep my status separate from any booking confirmation so both offices communicate the same position.

Answers and explanations, page 137

One useful distinction

Receipt means a message arrived. Acceptance of responsibility means someone has agreed to perform the next task. Neither proves that the resident is eligible or that a vehicle is booked. Record these different statuses separately in the shared request record.

E Conversation

Everyone is involved, but nobody has called the resident

Everyone is involved, but nobody has called the resident

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

lead contact / request reference / escalation contact / availability check / eligibility review / action owner / secure channel / acknowledgment of receipt / closed-loop handoff / joint status

01 **Jon:** We have a gap on Q41. The resident has heard from neither office. Our note says Transit to contact, but I cannot find an accepted handoff.

02 **Aisha:** We thought Community was the [1] _____. Let us assign that explicitly now rather than leave another shared note that neither office owns.

03 **Jon:** I will update the resident at 15:00 local time. I need your availability position early enough to explain what is still open.

04 **Aisha:** I will be the [2] _____ for the Transit status and send it to you by 14:30. That gives you a defined input before your contact.

05 **Jon:** Is that a booking confirmation, or simply the result of the availability check at that point?

06 **Aisha:** It is an [3] _____ status. We have not confirmed a vehicle or a booking. I will distinguish available, unavailable, and still under review rather than use the vague word arranged.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Jon:** Community still needs to complete its program review. I do not want either team to imply that the transport request itself establishes eligibility.

08 **Aisha:** Keep the [4] _____ with Community. Transit can report its resource position, but that does not replace your office's decision or remove the other service dependencies.

09 **Jon:** What do you need in the initial handoff? The file contains personal details that may not be relevant to checking a possible slot.

10 **Aisha:** Under the authorized exchange, send the [5] _____, pickup zone, and requested time window. We do not need the full medical file for that initial task.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Everyone is involved, but nobody has called the resident

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Jon:** I will use the approved channel and keep the information limited to that purpose. Should I send it to your personal work queue?

12 **Aisha:** Yes, through the designated [6] _____. I will confirm that it arrived and that I have accepted the availability task, not just that the message is visible.

13 **Jon:** That is where we lost the thread last time. Sent appeared in the record, and everyone read it as taken over. I will separate those statuses.

14 **Aisha:** An [7] _____ alone would not show ownership. I will record the next action and its deadline so your team can see what I have actually agreed to do.

15 **Jon:** If you still cannot confirm availability at 14:30, please tell me that rather than wait until you have a final answer.

16 **Aisha:** Agreed. The [8] _____ can explain the open questions. You should be able to give the resident the promised update even if the booking decision is still pending.

17 **Jon:** We also need a route if the internal update is missed or a dependency cannot be resolved within the available time.

18 **Aisha:** I will identify the [9] _____ in the record. That is a coordination route, not a promise to override eligibility requirements or create capacity that does not exist.

19 **Jon:** Let me read it back: you send the availability status by 14:30; I own the resident update at 15:00. Eligibility and booking remain unconfirmed.

20 **Aisha:** Correct. That is a [10] _____. I will confirm the transfer in Q41 and keep my status separate from any booking confirmation so both offices communicate the same position.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. lead contact / **2.** action owner / **3.** availability check / **4.** eligibility review / **5.** request reference / **6.** secure channel / **7.** acknowledgment of receipt / **8.** joint status / **9.** escalation contact / **10.** closed-loop handoff

Why these answers fit, page 138

F Check accuracy and scope

Everyone is involved, but nobody has called the resident

Return to the case

Request Q41 concerns accessible transport to a community appointment. The Community Office reviews program eligibility; the Transit Office checks vehicle availability and booking feasibility. Each office assumed the other would contact the resident. During a coordination call, Jon from Community agrees to own the resident update at 15:00 local time. Aisha from Transit will send an availability status to Jon by 14:30. Eligibility and a booking both remain unconfirmed. The authorized initial handoff needs the request reference, pickup zone, and requested time window, not the resident's full medical file.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which information belongs in the authorized initial exchange?

A. Every resident record held by either office
B. Request reference, pickup zone, and requested window
C. The full medical file by default
D. All unrelated case notes

2. What should happen if availability remains unknown at 14:30?

A. Both offices stay silent until a booking exists.
B. Jon announces a guaranteed vehicle anyway.
C. The resident-contact task silently disappears.
D. Aisha sends that status and the open question so Jon can give the promised update.

Answers and explanations, page 140

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 9-20; pause after the named recipient and accepted next action.

Shared work still needs named actions

Saying we are handling it can hide a gap between organizations. Assign one person to each action and repeat the recipient, deadline, and expected result. Keep responsibility for communicating progress distinct from authority to approve eligibility or confirm a booking.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Assign a second interagency update

For R52, Housing checks program eligibility and Mobility checks vehicle availability. Mobility officer Bea sends status to Housing officer Eli by 10:00. Eli contacts the resident at 10:30 local time. No booking is confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

Bea / Eli / 10:00 / 10:30 local time

01 **Coordinator:** The internal status owner is [1] _____.

02 **Officer:** The internal update deadline is [2] _____.

03 **Coordinator:** The resident-contact owner is [3] _____.

04 **Officer:** The resident update is at [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. Bea / **2.** 10:00 / **3.** Eli / **4.** 10:30 local time

Why these answers fit, page 140

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Everyone is involved, but nobody has called the resident". Jon: "That is where we lost the thread last time. Sent appeared in the record, and everyone read it as taken over. I will separate those statuses." Aisha: [missing response] Jon: "If you still cannot confirm availability at 14:30, please tell me that rather than wait until you have a final answer." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. It is an availability check status. We have not confirmed a vehicle or a booking. I will distinguish available, unavailable, and still under review rather than use the vague word arranged.

B. Correct. That is a closed-loop handoff. I will confirm the transfer in Q41 and keep my status separate from any booking confirmation so both offices communicate the same position.

C. An acknowledgment of receipt alone would not show ownership. I will record the next action and its deadline so your team can see what I have actually agreed to do.

D. Agreed. The joint status can explain the open questions. You should be able to give the resident the promised update even if the booking decision is still pending.

Answers and explanations, page 141

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / CONSTITUENT SERVICES AND ESCALATION

Repair a misdirected service request by explaining jurisdiction, confirming a referral, and preserving a separate complaint route.

A referral that does not send the resident in circles

Resident business owner Tessa has contacted three offices about placing a bench outside her shop. Licensing handles business registration, not permission to use the public sidewalk. Under this fictional town's process, Public Works Permit Intake receives the site plan and routes the sidewalk-use application for review. Service officer Ben has not yet confirmed that intake has accepted Tessa's referral. Ben can seek confirmation and call her Wednesday at 10:00 local time. That is a follow-up commitment, not a permit decision deadline. Her complaint about repeated redirection should be recorded separately from the permit application.

People: Tessa, Resident business owner; Ben, Constituent service officer.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which office receives the site plan under this process?

A. Business Licensing
B. The service officer's personal mailbox as a final decision route
C. An unspecified fourth office
D. Public Works Permit Intake

2. What is Ben's Wednesday 10:00 commitment?

A. A follow-up call about the referral
B. Guaranteed permit approval
C. Completion of all site inspections
D. Automatic acceptance of the site plan

3. How should the redirection complaint be recorded?

A. As proof that the permit must be granted
B. As withdrawal of the application
C. Only if Tessa stops asking about the bench
D. Separately from the permit application

Answers and explanations, page 142

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

constituent service
Assistance connecting people with public processes or offices.

provide constituent service

jurisdiction
The scope of an office's legal or assigned responsibility.

clarify jurisdiction

service remit
The defined matters an office handles.

explain the service remit

intake office
The unit receiving and initially routing requests or applications.

identify the intake office

referral
Direction or transfer of a matter to a relevant person or office.

make a referral

warm referral
A supported transfer that helps connect the person to the receiving office.

arrange a warm referral

referral acceptance
Confirmation that the receiving office has taken the referred matter.

verify referral acceptance

case summary
A concise account of the issue and relevant history.

prepare a case summary

service history
The record of contacts and actions concerning a service matter.

review the service history

business registration
Recording a business under the applicable registration process.

verify business registration

sidewalk-use permit
Permission under a local process for a specified use of a public sidewalk.

apply for a sidewalk-use permit

site plan
A drawing showing the location and layout relevant to a proposal.

submit a site plan

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

constituent service CONSTITUENT SERVICE

provide constituent service

Keep the meaning precise: Assistance connecting people with public processes or offices.

warm referral WARM REFERRAL

arrange a warm referral

Keep the meaning precise: A supported transfer that helps connect the person to the receiving office.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

application receipt

Confirmation that an application has arrived.

confirm application receipt

completeness review

Assessment of whether the required application items are present.

conduct a completeness review

substantive review

Assessment of the application's merits against the relevant requirements.

await substantive review

permit condition

A requirement attached to an issued permission.

explain permit conditions

follow-up call

A later contact to provide status or continue handling a matter.

schedule a follow-up call

response target

A planned time for a defined response.

state the response target

decision deadline

A time by which a decision is due under the applicable process.

verify the decision deadline

service complaint

A complaint about the handling or quality of a public service.

record a service complaint

complaint reference

An identifier for a complaint record.

provide the complaint reference

review route

The process for obtaining further examination of a matter.

explain the review route

case continuity

Preservation of relevant information across contacts or transfers.

maintain case continuity

closure reason

The documented explanation for closing a service record.

record the closure reason

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

site plan SITE PLAN

submit a site plan

Keep the meaning precise: A drawing showing the location and layout relevant to a proposal.

follow-up call FOLLOW-UP CALL

schedule a follow-up call

Keep the meaning precise: A later contact to provide status or continue handling a matter.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the history

You have already been redirected repeatedly.

Explain the first office

Licensing handles business registration.

Name the needed item

The stated intake process asks for a site plan.

Check the transfer

Has Permit Intake accepted the referral?

Limit personal information

I will use only the details needed for this referral.

Define the commitment

That call will report the referral status, not guarantee a permit decision.

Avoid compensation by approval

The service problem does not authorize me to grant the permit.

Provide a reference

I will give you the reference and responsible contact once confirmed.

Take responsibility for clarification

I will confirm the correct intake route before sending you elsewhere.

Explain the receiving office

Public Works Permit Intake receives the sidewalk-use application.

Avoid implied permission

Business registration does not itself authorize this sidewalk use.

Offer continuity

With the appropriate authorization, I will pass on the relevant case summary.

State the follow-up

I will call Wednesday at 10:00 local time.

Keep the complaint separate

I will record the redirection complaint separately from the application.

Explain the next stage

Receipt is followed by the applicable completeness and substantive review.

Close accurately

I will not mark the matter resolved merely because an email was sent.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Explain the receiving office
Useful wording: Public Works Permit Intake receives the sidewalk-use application.

Purpose: Name the needed item
Useful wording: The stated intake process asks for a site plan.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which explanation gives a useful referral?

A. Your complaint means no application is needed.

B. Licensing handles registration; Public Works Permit Intake receives the sidewalk application and site plan.

C. Try another office; they probably know.

D. Registration automatically permits every sidewalk use.

2. Which follow-up statement is accurate?

A. Receipt means every permit condition is satisfied.

B. A sent email proves the intake team accepted the case.

C. I will call Wednesday at 10:00 local time with the referral status.

D. Your permit will be approved by Wednesday at 10:00.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The unit receiving and initially routing requests or applications. Which term fits?

A. service history

B. substantive review

C. complaint reference

D. intake office

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A referral that does not send the resident in circles". Tessa: "I have a drawing showing where the bench would go and how much space would remain. Is that the document they need first?" Ben: [missing response] Tessa: "Can you transfer the information I have already given? I do not want to start the story again with a fourth person." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Only the status update. A decision deadline for the permit has not been established here. Receipt, completeness review, and substantive review are different stages, and I cannot collapse them into that call.

B. I will record a separate service complaint about the handling. That does not replace your application or decide whether the bench meets the requirements, but the service concern should be addressed.

C. The stated intake item is a site plan. I can confirm their submission requirements, but I should not say your drawing is complete or approved before the receiving team checks it.

D. Correct. I will not use sent an email as the closure reason for a resolved case. The record should show the actual handoff status, the remaining action, and who owns it.

Answers and explanations, page 142

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Registration of a business does not automatically authorize use of public space. The fictional town assigns the sidewalk application to Public Works Permit Intake. Explain that role clearly, but do not present the same office structure or permit process as universal.

E Conversation

A referral that does not send the resident in circles

A referral that does not send the resident in circles

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

site plan / closure reason / case summary / decision deadline / case continuity / service complaint / Referral acceptance / sidewalk-use permit / follow-up call / service remit

01 **Tessa:** I have explained this bench three times. Licensing sent me elsewhere, and I was sent back. Before I join another queue, can someone tell me who actually handles it?

02 **Ben:** I am sorry about the repeated redirection. Let us clarify the [1] _____ before I send you anywhere else. Licensing handles business registration, which is different from permission to use the public sidewalk.

03 **Tessa:** My business is registered, so I thought that office could confirm whether the bench is allowed outside the shop.

04 **Ben:** A [2] _____ follows a different process here. Public Works Permit Intake receives that application and the site plan, then routes it for the relevant review.

05 **Tessa:** I have a drawing showing where the bench would go and how much space would remain. Is that the document they need first?

06 **Ben:** The stated intake item is a [3] _____. I can confirm their submission requirements, but I should not say your drawing is complete or approved before the receiving team checks it.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Tessa:** Can you transfer the information I have already given? I do not want to start the story again with a fourth person.

08 **Ben:** With the appropriate authorization, I can pass on a relevant [4] _____. I will include the bench request and previous contacts, using only the details needed for this referral through the approved route.

09 **Tessa:** That would help. But is someone at Public Works taking it on, or will I arrive with another email that nobody has picked up?

10 **Ben:** [5] _____ is not confirmed yet. I will seek that confirmation and identify the responsible contact instead of treating an outgoing email as a completed handoff.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A referral that does not send the resident in circles

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Tessa:** When will I hear from you? I need something more specific than soon because I am planning the shop opening.

12 **Ben:** I can make a [6] _____ on Wednesday at 10:00 local time. I will tell you whether intake has accepted the referral and what the next step is.

13 **Tessa:** Does that mean I will have a permit decision by Wednesday morning, or only information about where the application stands?

14 **Ben:** Only the status update. A [7] _____ for the permit has not been established here. Receipt, completeness review, and substantive review are different stages, and I cannot collapse them into that call.

15 **Tessa:** I also want the repeated redirection recorded as a complaint. That has cost time even if the permit process still has work to do.

16 **Ben:** I will record a separate [8] _____ about the handling. That does not replace your application or decide whether the bench meets the requirements, but the service concern should be addressed.

17 **Tessa:** Please keep both references clear. I do not want the complaint to cause the application to disappear from the system.

18 **Ben:** I will maintain [9] _____ while distinguishing the records. When the references and receiving contact are confirmed, I will explain which one to quote for each purpose.

19 **Tessa:** Then I will expect your Wednesday call about the referral, and the complaint will follow its own review route.

20 **Ben:** Correct. I will not use sent an email as the [10] _____ for a resolved case. The record should show the actual handoff status, the remaining action, and who owns it.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. service remit / **2.** sidewalk-use permit / **3.** site plan / **4.** case summary / **5.** Referral acceptance / **6.** follow-up call / **7.** decision deadline / **8.** service complaint / **9.** case continuity / **10.** closure reason

Why these answers fit, page 143

F Check accuracy and scope

A referral that does not send the resident in circles

Return to the case

Resident business owner Tessa has contacted three offices about placing a bench outside her shop. Licensing handles business registration, not permission to use the public sidewalk. Under this fictional town's process, Public Works Permit Intake receives the site plan and routes the sidewalk-use application for review. Service officer Ben has not yet confirmed that intake has accepted Tessa's referral. Ben can seek confirmation and call her Wednesday at 10:00 local time. That is a follow-up commitment, not a permit decision deadline. Her complaint about repeated redirection should be recorded separately from the permit application.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What preserves case continuity?

A. An authorized relevant summary and confirmation of the receiving contact
B. Requiring the resident to restart without checking the record
C. Sending unrelated personal files to every office
D. Closing the case when the first email leaves

2. How should the complaint affect the permit decision?

A. It should be handled separately, without pre-deciding the permit.
B. It automatically guarantees approval.
C. It automatically disqualifies the applicant.
D. It replaces the site plan.

Answers and explanations, page 145

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20 and distinguish the application from the service complaint.

Explain the reason for the referral

Another office name can sound like another rejection unless the resident understands its role. Acknowledge the repeated redirection, explain the receiving office's function, and confirm the handoff. Avoid promising a permit as compensation for a frustrating service experience.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Repair another referral

For a fictional street-banner application, Events Registration records the event but Road Use Intake receives the banner plan. Officer Hana promises a referral-status call on Thursday at 14:00 local time. No permit decision is promised.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

Road Use Intake / Thursday at 14:00 local time / referral status / Hana

01 **Resident:** The office receiving the banner plan is [1] _____.

02 **Officer:** The promised follow-up owner is [2] _____.

03 **Resident:** The call is scheduled for [3] _____.

04 **Officer:** The call concerns [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. Road Use Intake / **2.** Hana / **3.** Thursday at 14:00 local time / **4.** referral status

Why these answers fit, page 145

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A referral that does not send the resident in circles". Tessa: "Does that mean I will have a permit decision by Wednesday morning, or only information about where the application stands?" Ben: [missing response] Tessa: "I also want the repeated redirection recorded as a complaint. That has cost time even if the permit process still has work to do." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. With the appropriate authorization, I can pass on a relevant case summary. I will include the bench request and previous contacts, using only the details needed for this referral through the approved route.

B. I am sorry about the repeated redirection. Let us clarify the service remit before I send you anywhere else. Licensing handles business registration, which is different from permission to use the public sidewalk.

C. Only the status update. A decision deadline for the permit has not been established here. Receipt, completeness review, and substantive review are different stages, and I cannot collapse them into that call.

D. The stated intake item is a site plan. I can confirm their submission requirements, but I should not say your drawing is complete or approved before the receiving team checks it.

Answers and explanations, page 146

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Interagency Coordination" and "Constituent Services and Escalation". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The office sending a matter to another responsible team. Which term fits?

A. acknowledgment of receipt
B. secure channel
C. referring office
D. request reference

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A concise account of the issue and relevant history. Which term fits?

A. decision deadline
B. application receipt
C. case summary
D. constituent service

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence". Sana: "The draft issue note calls it fraud. All we know so far is that the record is missing. I want the wording to reflect that distinction." Owen: [missing response] Sana: "If you find the record, does that automatically settle whether the grant can pay for the cost?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will keep the variance visible until it is resolved through that process. We can be precise about the gap without either hiding it or claiming more than the evidence shows.
B. Call it an unsupported item at this stage. Missing support does not by itself establish intent. We can state exactly what is absent and what we are doing to obtain it.
C. Available budget does not determine the budget category of an actual transaction. We should not reclassify the item simply to remove the visible gap. The treatment needs evidence and the proper review.
D. No. Allowable cost status depends on the applicable rules and award terms as well. The record supports the transaction; the reviewer still needs the relevant basis for charging it to the award.

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A referral that does not send the resident in circles". Tessa: "Please keep both references clear. I do not want the complaint to cause the application to disappear from the system." Ben: [missing response] Tessa: "Then I will expect your Wednesday call about the referral, and the complaint will follow its own review route." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Referral acceptance is not confirmed yet. I will seek that confirmation and identify the responsible contact instead of treating an outgoing email as a completed handoff.

B. I will maintain case continuity while distinguishing the records. When the references and receiving contact are confirmed, I will explain which one to quote for each purpose.

C. I can make a follow-up call on Wednesday at 10:00 local time. I will tell you whether intake has accepted the referral and what the next step is.

D. A sidewalk-use permit follows a different process here. Public Works Permit Intake receives that application and the site plan, then routes it for the relevant review.

Answers and explanations, page 162

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / TRANSPARENCY, RECORDS, AND ETHICS

Explain a federal records-review status without promising full release or using a possible exemption as a blanket refusal.

> **Found records are not automatically cleared records**
>
> A fictional U.S. federal agency receives request F77 for signed service contracts and their attachments from January through March. Staff locate eight responsive contract files. Two contain personal contact details requiring review; no release or withholding decision has been made. An initial acknowledgment mistakenly promises that every page will be released automatically. Records officer Imani and program liaison Cole must correct the promise, preserve the records, and explain the review process. The presence of potentially protected information does not itself authorize withholding an entire file. Applicable disclosure standards and any partial release must be assessed by the responsible staff.

People: Imani, Records officer; Cole, Program liaison.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What has been established?

A. Every page has been cleared for release.
B. All eight files must be withheld.
C. No records exist.
D. Eight responsive contract files have been located.

2. What needs correction?

A. The promise of automatic full release
B. The January-through-March request scope
C. The number eight without contrary evidence
D. The need to preserve responsive records

3. What follows from personal details appearing in two files?

A. Every page must be released without review.
B. The entire request can be treated as nonexistent.
C. Those details require review; full-file withholding is not automatic.
D. Both files are automatically excluded in full.

Answers and explanations, page 147

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

FOIA
Freedom of Information Act; the U.S. federal records-access law.

process a FOIA request

records request
A request for access to identified or described records.

clarify a records request

request scope
The boundaries of the records sought.

confirm the request scope

responsive record
A record falling within the request's description.

identify responsive records

records custodian
The person or unit responsible for relevant records.

contact the records custodian

search terms
Words or criteria used to locate relevant records.

document the search terms

date range
The start and end period limiting a search or request.

confirm the date range

attachment
A file or document included with another record.

review the attachments

acknowledgment
A response confirming receipt of a request.

issue an acknowledgment

tracking number
A reference used to follow a request's progress.

quote the tracking number

disclosure review
Assessment of what information can or must be released.

conduct disclosure review

exemption
A legal provision potentially permitting or requiring specified information to be withheld.

assess an exemption

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

FOIA FOIA

process a FOIA request

Keep the meaning precise: Freedom of Information Act; the U.S. federal records-access law.

search terms SEARCH TERMS

document the search terms

Keep the meaning precise: Words or criteria used to locate relevant records.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

foreseeable harm

The expected harm considered under the applicable federal withholding standard.

assess foreseeable harm

segregable information

Information that can be separated from protected material for release.

identify segregable information

withholding basis

The legal and factual reason supporting nondisclosure.

document the withholding basis

release copy

The version prepared for disclosure after the applicable review.

verify the release copy

retention schedule

A rule or policy governing how long records are retained and disposed of.

follow the retention schedule

redaction

Removal or masking of protected information from a released copy.

apply justified redactions

partial release

Disclosure of releasable portions while other information is withheld under an applicable basis.

prepare a partial release

personal privacy

An individual's interest in protection of personal information.

assess personal-privacy interests

records preservation

Keeping records intact under applicable requirements.

maintain records preservation

administrative appeal

A request for agency-level review of an initial decision.

explain the administrative appeal route

B Precision and professional shorthand / continued

public liaison

A designated contact helping requesters understand or resolve process concerns.

contact the public liaison

review status

The current position of an assessment before or after a decision.

explain the review status

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

exemption EXEMPTION

assess an exemption

Keep the meaning precise: A legal provision potentially permitting or requiring specified information to be withheld.

withholding basis WITHHOLDING BASIS

document the withholding basis

Keep the meaning precise: The legal and factual reason supporting nondisclosure.

C Phrases that move the work forward

State the search result

We located eight responsive contract files.

Separate stages

Located does not mean cleared for release.

Describe the pending review

Two files contain personal details that require review.

Ask for the basis

What applicable legal and factual basis supports the proposed withholding?

Preserve the source

Keep the original records intact under the applicable requirements.

Avoid an invented date

We should provide the actual process status, not an unsupported release deadline.

Explain responsibility

The records team will make the disclosure assessment.

Provide the relevant route

The response should explain the applicable review or appeal information.

Retain the request scope

The request covers signed contracts and attachments from January through March.

Correct the earlier promise

The acknowledgment should not have promised automatic full disclosure.

Avoid a blanket refusal

Their presence does not automatically justify withholding the entire files.

Check partial disclosure

Which information can be separated and released?

Distinguish the copy

Any justified redactions belong in the reviewed release copy.

Keep the reference

Please use F77 in the correction and subsequent updates.

Document the reasoning

Retain the review decision and its supporting basis.

Close accurately

We can report progress without predicting an unmade disclosure decision.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Correct the earlier promise
Useful wording: The acknowledgment should not have promised automatic full disclosure.

Purpose: Describe the pending review
Useful wording: Two files contain personal details that require review.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which update is accurate?

A. Eight responsive files were located; disclosure review remains underway.
B. Eight files were found, so every page is automatically public.
C. Two personal details justify refusing every record.
D. The search found nothing because review is incomplete.

2. How should the earlier acknowledgment be handled?

A. Correct the automatic-release promise and explain the actual review status.
B. Wait for final review before mentioning the inaccurate promise.
C. Replace the promise with a full-withholding notice for the two files.
D. Reissue a receipt notice without acknowledging the earlier assurance.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A record falling within the request's description. Which term fits?

A. acknowledgment
B. segregable information
C. responsive record
D. retention schedule

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Found records are not automatically cleared records". Cole: "I can flag the affected files for review. I would rather not send a blanket withholding message before anyone has looked at the individual details. Is that right?" Imani: [missing response] Cole: "Then the team should distinguish the contact details from the rest of the contract material, rather than treating each file as indivisible." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. A possible exemption needs review against the actual information and applicable standard. Personal details do not automatically settle the treatment of every page in those files.

B. Keep that request scope visible in the record. We should not silently broaden or narrow the request, and any genuine ambiguity should be handled through the appropriate clarification process.

C. Yes, assess segregable information. The responsible reviewers must examine what can be released and document any valid withholding basis, including the relevant harm analysis where the law requires it.

D. First separate responsive records from records cleared for disclosure. The files match the request, but the release assessment is not finished. That acknowledgment promises more than we can support.

Answers and explanations, page 147

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Responsive means within the request scope; it does not mean cleared for release. The eight files match the stated contract request. Personal details in two files require review, but their presence alone does not decide the fate of every page.

E Conversation

Found records are not automatically cleared records

Found records are not automatically cleared records

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

redaction / acknowledgment / segregable information / records preservation / administrative appeal / exemption / partial release / review status / responsive records / request scope

01 **Cole:** I need to correct our F77 acknowledgment. We located eight files, but the letter promised every page. Two contain personal contact details that have not been reviewed.

02 **Imani:** First separate [1] _____ from records cleared for disclosure. The files match the request, but the release assessment is not finished. That acknowledgment promises more than we can support.

03 **Cole:** The request is for signed service contracts and their attachments from January through March. We have not been asked for every email about the projects.

04 **Imani:** Keep that [2] _____ visible in the record. We should not silently broaden or narrow the request, and any genuine ambiguity should be handled through the appropriate clarification process.

05 **Cole:** I can flag the affected files for review. I would rather not send a blanket withholding message before anyone has looked at the individual details. Is that right?

06 **Imani:** Yes. A possible [3] _____ needs review against the actual information and applicable standard. Personal details do not automatically settle the treatment of every page in those files.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Cole:** Then the team should distinguish the contact details from the rest of the contract material, rather than treating each file as indivisible.

08 **Imani:** Yes, assess [4] _____. The responsible reviewers must examine what can be released and document any valid withholding basis, including the relevant harm analysis where the law requires it.

09 **Cole:** I do not want to alter the originals while preparing the material for review. What should the program team preserve?

10 **Imani:** Follow [5] _____ requirements and keep the source records intact. Preparation of a disclosure version is not permission to rewrite or delete the originals to make the request easier to handle.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Found records are not automatically cleared records

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Cole:** If the review supports removing particular details, we would work from a separate version for disclosure.

12 **Imani:** Correct. Any justified [6] _____ belongs in the reviewed release copy, with the required basis and explanation. Do not obscure material simply because it is embarrassing or inconvenient for the office.

13 **Cole:** The requester may feel we are changing our position after promising full release. How should I explain the correction?

14 **Imani:** Correct the [7] _____ directly. Say that the earlier automatic-release assurance was inaccurate, that eight responsive files were located, and that disclosure review is still underway.

15 **Cole:** Should we give a new release date now, so the correction does not sound vague?

16 **Imani:** Give the actual [8] _____ and any properly established process information. Do not invent a deadline to compensate for the earlier promise. The responsible team should confirm any applicable timing statement.

17 **Cole:** We will retain the file references, the decision record, and the explanation of anything ultimately withheld.

18 **Imani:** Also check the [9] _____ position where full disclosure is not possible. The response should reflect the actual review, not a blanket choice between releasing everything and releasing nothing.

19 **Cole:** I will route the correction through the records team and keep F77 attached to the search and review history.

20 **Imani:** Good. When a decision is issued, provide the applicable [10] _____ information and relevant contacts. We can be transparent about the process while leaving the substantive disclosure decision with the authorized reviewers.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. responsive records / **2.** request scope / **3.** exemption / **4.** segregable information / **5.** records preservation / **6.** redaction / **7.** acknowledgment / **8.** review status / **9.** partial release / **10.** administrative appeal

Why these answers fit, page 148

F Check accuracy and scope

Found records are not automatically cleared records

Return to the case

A fictional U.S. federal agency receives request F77 for signed service contracts and their attachments from January through March. Staff locate eight responsive contract files. Two contain personal contact details requiring review; no release or withholding decision has been made. An initial acknowledgment mistakenly promises that every page will be released automatically. Records officer Imani and program liaison Cole must correct the promise, preserve the records, and explain the review process. The presence of potentially protected information does not itself authorize withholding an entire file. Applicable disclosure standards and any partial release must be assessed by the responsible staff.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What is the right response to a proposed full-file withholding?

A. Ask for the applicable basis and assess whether releasable portions can be separated.
B. Accept it solely because one page contains contact details.
C. Assume all personal information must always be published.
D. Stop preserving the file because release is uncertain.

2. What should remain intact?

A. No records once a possible exemption is noticed
B. The source records under applicable preservation requirements
C. Only the final email to the requester
D. A rewritten original with inconvenient details removed

Answers and explanations, page 150

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 9-20; make the acknowledgment correction direct and specific.

Transparency needs accurate status language

A requester can deserve a clear explanation even when review is unfinished. Distinguish records found from records cleared for release. Do not use privacy as a vague excuse, but do not promise to disclose personal details before the appropriate review.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Describe another records-review status

Request C44 covers final inspection reports for April. Six responsive files are found. One contains information requiring review. No release or withholding decision has been made.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

not yet made / April / C44 / six responsive files

01 **Liaison:** The request reference is [1] _____.

02 **Officer:** The search found [2] _____.

03 **Liaison:** The requested month is [3] _____.

04 **Officer:** The disclosure decision is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. C44 / **2.** six responsive files / **3.** April / **4.** not yet made

Why these answers fit, page 150

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Found records are not automatically cleared records". Cole: "The requester may feel we are changing our position after promising full release. How should I explain the correction?" Imani: [missing response] Cole: "Should we give a new release date now, so the correction does not sound vague?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep that request scope visible in the record. We should not silently broaden or narrow the request, and any genuine ambiguity should be handled through the appropriate clarification process.

B. Correct the acknowledgment directly. Say that the earlier automatic-release assurance was inaccurate, that eight responsive files were located, and that disclosure review is still underway.

C. Yes. A possible exemption needs review against the actual information and applicable standard. Personal details do not automatically settle the treatment of every page in those files.

D. First separate responsive records from records cleared for disclosure. The files match the request, but the release assessment is not finished. That acknowledgment promises more than we can support.

Answers and explanations, page 151

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / PERFORMANCE METRICS AND BUDGET JUSTIFICATION

Explain outputs, response rates, and observed outcomes while keeping a budget request separate from a causal success claim.

Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome

A fictional employment program requests $240,000 for next year after spending $200,000 this year. It delivered 20 workshops and recorded 400 attendances, which include repeat visits. In the previous follow-up cohort, 200 of 250 invited people responded and 80 respondents reported employment at 90 days. In the current cohort, 210 of 300 responded and 105 reported employment. The respondent employment rates are 40% and 50%, while response rates are 80% and 70%. Analyst Faye and budget officer Luis must explain the figures without counting attendances as unique people or claiming the program caused the observed change.

People: Faye, Program analyst; Luis, Budget officer.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What do the 400 attendances count?

A. Visits, including repeat visits
B. Exactly 400 unique people
C. Exactly 400 people gaining employment
D. Only survey respondents

2. What is the current respondent employment rate?

A. 40%
B. 50%
C. 35%
D. 70%

3. How much does the requested budget exceed current spending?

A. $240,000, or 120%
B. $40,000, or 20%
C. $20,000, or 10%
D. $40,000, or 40%

Answers and explanations, page 152

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

budget justification
The evidence and reasoning supporting a funding request.

strengthen the budget justification

budget request
A proposal for future funding.

submit a budget request

input
A resource used to deliver an activity or service.

identify program inputs

output
A direct product or count of services delivered.

measure outputs

impact
A broader or causally attributed effect, depending on the evaluation definition.

assess program impact

unique participant
A distinct person counted once within the defined scope.

count unique participants

appropriation
Funding authority granted through the applicable legislative process.

distinguish a request from an appropriation

actual expenditure
The amount spent under the stated accounting basis and period.

report actual expenditure

activity
Work carried out by a program.

describe program activities

outcome
A change or result experienced by the target population.

measure outcomes

attendance
A recorded instance of participation, which may include repeat visits.

count attendances

cohort
A defined group observed over a particular period.

compare cohorts

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

budget justification BUDGET JUSTIFICATION

strengthen the budget justification

Keep the meaning precise: The evidence and reasoning supporting a funding request.

activity ACTIVITY

describe program activities

Keep the meaning precise: Work carried out by a program.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

follow-up survey

A later survey collecting information after a service or event.

conduct a follow-up survey

respondent

A person who supplies a survey response.

identify respondents

percentage point

The unit used for the difference between two percentages.

report percentage-point change

nonresponse bias

Distortion that may arise when respondents differ systematically from nonrespondents.

assess nonresponse bias

attribution

Assignment of an observed result to a particular cause.

support causal attribution

performance target

A specified intended level of achievement.

set a performance target

response rate

The share of invited eligible people who provide a response under the stated definition.

calculate the response rate

denominator

The quantity by which another quantity is divided to calculate a rate.

state the denominator

relative change

The difference expressed as a share of the starting value.

distinguish relative change

selection effect

A difference arising from how people enter or remain in a measured group.

examine selection effects

counterfactual

An estimate of what would have happened without the intervention.

define the counterfactual

measurement plan

A defined approach to collecting and interpreting performance evidence.

develop the measurement plan

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

cohort COHORT

compare cohorts

Keep the meaning precise: A defined group observed over a particular period.

percentage point PERCENTAGE POINT

report percentage-point change

Keep the meaning precise: The unit used for the difference between two percentages.

C Phrases that move the work forward

State the funding request

We are requesting two hundred forty thousand dollars for next year.

Compare with actual spending

This year we spent two hundred thousand dollars.

Quantify the increase

The request is forty thousand dollars higher, a twenty-percent increase.

Name the output

We delivered twenty workshops.

Keep the count accurate

The four hundred attendances include repeat visits.

Avoid a reach claim

We cannot call that four hundred unique participants.

Define the outcome measure

We measured reported employment among respondents at ninety days.

State the current denominator

The current rate is 105 out of 210 respondents.

Compare the rates

The respondent employment rate rose from forty to fifty percent.

Use the correct unit

That is a ten-percentage-point increase.

Separate relative change

Relative to forty percent, the increase is twenty-five percent.

Disclose response coverage

The response rate fell from eighty to seventy percent.

Avoid causal overstatement

These observations do not establish that the program caused the change.

Explain the evidence gap

We need better information about nonrespondents and cohort differences.

Connect money to delivery

The request needs a costed plan, not only a list of past activities.

Close the justification

Show the outputs, observed outcomes, limitations, and proposed measurement plan together.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Name the output
Useful wording: We delivered twenty workshops.

Purpose: Keep the count accurate
Useful wording: The four hundred attendances include repeat visits.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which headline is supported?

A. The response rate rose to eighty percent this year.

B. Reported employment among respondents rose from 40% to 50%; response coverage changed.

C. The program caused a ten-percent improvement for every participant.

D. Four hundred different residents gained jobs.

2. How should the employment-rate difference be stated?

A. Ten percent relative and twenty-five percentage points

B. Fifty percentage points

C. A decrease of ten percentage points

D. Ten percentage points, equivalent to a 25% relative increase from 40%

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The amount spent under the stated accounting basis and period. Which term fits?

A. respondent

B. impact

C. attribution

D. actual expenditure

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome". Luis: "Walk me through that measure. I want the numerator and denominator stated before we describe an improvement." Faye: [missing response] Luis: "That gives forty percent and fifty percent among respondents. It does not tell us the employment rate among everyone invited." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will present the outputs, respondent outcomes, response rates, and a measurement plan alongside the costed proposal. That gives the funding discussion a clear basis without claiming a causal success we have not established.

B. The supplied total is not a unique participant count. I will not convert it into one. The follow-up survey provides a separate set of observations, with its own defined groups and response coverage.

C. The absolute difference is ten percentage points. Relative to the earlier forty-percent rate, that is a twenty-five-percent increase. I will use the first description and label the relative comparison if we include it.

D. In the earlier cohort, eighty of two hundred respondents reported employment at ninety days. In the current cohort, one hundred five of two hundred ten respondents reported employment at the same follow-up point.

Answers and explanations, page 152

One useful distinction

The employment rates use respondents as the denominator: 80/200 = 40% and 105/210 = 50%. The change is ten percentage points, or 25% relative to 40%. These are observed respondent outcomes, not established results for every invited person.

E Conversation

Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome

Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

measurement plan / Nonresponse bias / percentage points / budget request / output / cohort / unique participant / attribution / response rate / denominator

01 **Luis:** The workshop count tells me what we delivered. Before we ask for two hundred forty thousand next year, show me what we know about the people who attended.

02 **Faye:** The workshops are an [1] _____, not the outcome itself. We also recorded four hundred attendances, but that includes repeat visits and should not be presented as four hundred different people.

03 **Luis:** Do we have a reliable count of distinct participants, or are those repeat visits still mixed together?

04 **Faye:** The supplied total is not a [2] _____ count. I will not convert it into one. The follow-up survey provides a separate set of observations, with its own defined groups and response coverage.

05 **Luis:** Walk me through that measure. I want the numerator and denominator stated before we describe an improvement.

06 **Faye:** In the earlier [3] _____, eighty of two hundred respondents reported employment at ninety days. In the current cohort, one hundred five of two hundred ten respondents reported employment at the same follow-up point.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Luis:** That gives forty percent and fifty percent among respondents. It does not tell us the employment rate among everyone invited.

08 **Faye:** Correct. The [4] _____ is respondents in each case. The note should keep that visible so readers do not assume complete follow-up or an outcome measured for every participant.

09 **Luis:** The draft says employment improved by ten percent. That wording could be read differently from the calculation we just made.

10 **Faye:** The absolute difference is ten [5] _____. Relative to the earlier forty-percent rate, that is a twenty-five-percent increase. I will use the first description and label the relative comparison if we include it.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Luis:** How many people were invited to respond in each cohort? Different response patterns could affect the comparison.

12 **Faye:** The [6] _____ was two hundred out of two hundred fifty before, and two hundred ten out of three hundred now. That is eighty percent before and seventy percent now.

13 **Luis:** So the observed respondent rate improved while survey coverage fell. We should not hide either part of that picture.

14 **Faye:** Agreed. [7] _____ is a question to assess, not a result we can quantify from these figures alone. We need better information about missing responses and differences between the groups.

15 **Luis:** The draft says the workshops drove the increase. I see a before-and-after comparison, but no estimate of what would have happened without the program.

16 **Faye:** The evidence does not support that [8] _____. We have observed outcomes, but no design here establishing what would have happened without the program or accounting for other influences.

17 **Luis:** Then connect the request to a costed future plan as well. This year's actual spending was two hundred thousand, not two hundred forty thousand.

18 **Faye:** The [9] _____ is forty thousand higher, a twenty-percent increase. It still needs a delivery plan and explanation of the additional resources, not just a larger activity claim.

Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome / continued

19 **Luis:** Keep the useful results, but make the limits readable. A careful explanation will help the reviewer understand what the evidence can and cannot support.

20 **Faye:** I will present the outputs, respondent outcomes, response rates, and a [10] _____ alongside the costed proposal. That gives the funding discussion a clear basis without claiming a causal success we have not established.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. output / **2.** unique participant / **3.** cohort / **4.** denominator / **5.** percentage points / **6.** response rate / **7.** Nonresponse bias / **8.** attribution / **9.** budget request / **10.** measurement plan

Why these answers fit, page 153

F Check accuracy and scope

Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome

Return to the case

A fictional employment program requests $240,000 for next year after spending $200,000 this year. It delivered 20 workshops and recorded 400 attendances, which include repeat visits. In the previous follow-up cohort, 200 of 250 invited people responded and 80 respondents reported employment at 90 days. In the current cohort, 210 of 300 responded and 105 reported employment. The respondent employment rates are 40% and 50%, while response rates are 80% and 70%. Analyst Faye and budget officer Luis must explain the figures without counting attendances as unique people or claiming the program caused the observed change.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which comparison describes survey response?

A. Both cohorts had complete response
B. Previous 80%; current 70%
C. Previous 40%; current 50%
D. Previous 70%; current 80%

2. What does the budget request still need?

A. Only a larger attendance headline
B. A claim that the requested amount is already appropriated
C. An assumption that all nonrespondents found work
D. A costed delivery and measurement plan with limits stated

Answers and explanations, page 155

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20 and read both response rates before discussing the funding request.

A useful challenge improves the public explanation

A budget reviewer may ask what changed for residents rather than how busy the team was. Answer with definitions, denominators, and limits. Preserve genuine activity and outcome evidence without treating a request for better measurement as dismissal of the staff's work.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Compare a second program measure

An earlier cohort has 30 employed respondents out of 100 respondents. A later cohort has 48 out of 120. Current spending is $150,000 and the next-year request is $180,000. No causal evaluation is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

10 percentage points / 40% / 30% / $30,000

01 **Analyst:** The earlier respondent employment rate is [1] _____.

02 **Reviewer:** The later respondent employment rate is [2] _____.

03 **Analyst:** The increase in those rates is [3] _____.

04 **Reviewer:** The requested funding increase is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 30% / **2.** 40% / **3.** 10 percentage points / **4.** $30,000

Why these answers fit, page 155

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome". Luis: "So the observed respondent rate improved while survey coverage fell. We should not hide either part of that picture." Faye: [missing response] Luis: "The draft says the workshops drove the increase. I see a before-and-after comparison, but no estimate of what would have happened without the program." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. The denominator is respondents in each case. The note should keep that visible so readers do not assume complete follow-up or an outcome measured for every participant.

B. The workshops are an output, not the outcome itself. We also recorded four hundred attendances, but that includes repeat visits and should not be presented as four hundred different people.

C. The response rate was two hundred out of two hundred fifty before, and two hundred ten out of three hundred now. That is eighty percent before and seventy percent now.

D. Agreed. Nonresponse bias is a question to assess, not a result we can quantify from these figures alone. We need better information about missing responses and differences between the groups.

Answers and explanations, page 156

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Transparency, Records, and Ethics" and "Performance Metrics and Budget Justification". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The boundaries of the records sought. Which term fits?

A. redaction
B. records preservation
C. request scope
D. attachment

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A change or result experienced by the target population. Which term fits?

A. nonresponse bias
B. budget justification
C. follow-up survey
D. outcome

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A referral that does not send the resident in circles". Tessa: "That would help. But is someone at Public Works taking it on, or will I arrive with another email that nobody has picked up?" Ben: [missing response] Tessa: "When will I hear from you? I need something more specific than soon because I am planning the shop opening." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Referral acceptance is not confirmed yet. I will seek that confirmation and identify the responsible contact instead of treating an outgoing email as a completed handoff.
B. A sidewalk-use permit follows a different process here. Public Works Permit Intake receives that application and the site plan, then routes it for the relevant review.
C. I will maintain case continuity while distinguishing the records. When the references and receiving contact are confirmed, I will explain which one to quote for each purpose.
D. I can make a follow-up call on Wednesday at 10:00 local time. I will tell you whether intake has accepted the referral and what the next step is.

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome". Luis: "Then connect the request to a costed future plan as well. This year's actual spending was two hundred thousand, not two hundred forty thousand." Faye: [missing response] Luis: "Keep the useful results, but make the limits readable. A careful explanation will help the reviewer understand what the evidence can and cannot support." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The budget request is forty thousand higher, a twenty-percent increase. It still needs a delivery plan and explanation of the additional resources, not just a larger activity claim.

B. The workshops are an output, not the outcome itself. We also recorded four hundred attendances, but that includes repeat visits and should not be presented as four hundred different people.

C. The evidence does not support that attribution. We have observed outcomes, but no design here establishing what would have happened without the program or accounting for other influences.

D. Correct. The denominator is respondents in each case. The note should keep that visible so readers do not assume complete follow-up or an outcome measured for every participant.

Answers and explanations, page 164

Language for the next case

The amendment passed; the proposal did not

quorum

Quorum is the minimum presence required to conduct the business; five members were present, exceeding the fictional committee's requirement of four.

Felix: We had a quorum throughout: five present against a requirement of four. The problem is the recorded outcome, not attendance.

amendment

The amendment changed the proposed pilot's duration from six months to three; adopting that change did not adopt the pilot itself.

Felix: That amendment passed. But I then put the revised main motion to the committee, and the votes were different.

majority

A majority here means more than half of votes actually cast; the fictional rule excludes abstentions, so three affirmative votes are needed when four votes are cast.

Felix: Under our stated rule, the majority is based on votes cast, not all seven members or all five present. Four votes were cast on each question.

abstention

An abstention records that a present member did not vote; under these supplied rules it is excluded from votes cast rather than counted as a no.

Felix: Correct. Record the abstention accurately, but do not turn it into a third no. We still need the record to distinguish a tie from a two-to-three defeat.

main motion as amended

The main motion as amended is the substantive proposal with the adopted change incorporated; it still needed its own successful vote, which it did not receive.

Felix: No. The change became part of the main motion as amended. Its later defeat means the committee did not authorize that revised proposal.

roll-call vote

A roll-call vote identifies individual members' recorded responses; it supports verification of the totals and preserves the distinction among yes, no, and abstention.

Felix: Remove that. The roll-call vote gives us the actual responses. There is no need for a broader label that contradicts them.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

The amendment passed; the proposal did not

Fictional committee rules: seven members; quorum four; five present throughout. Adoption requires more than half of votes cast, excluding abstentions. An amendment changes a proposed pilot from six months to three. Its vote is 3 yes, 1 no, 1 abstention. The subsequent main motion as amended receives 2 yes, 2 no, 1 abstention. These stipulated rules are not universal public-body law.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

quorum / abstention / majority / main motion as amended / roll-call vote / amendment

01 **Nora:** Before you sign the minutes, we need to separate the two votes. The draft says the three-month pilot was approved, but that is not what the record shows.

02 **Felix:** We had a [1] _____ throughout: five present against a requirement of four. The problem is the recorded outcome, not attendance.

03 **Nora:** Agreed. First, the committee voted on changing six months to three. Three voted yes, one no, and one abstained.

04 **Felix:** That [2] _____ passed. But I then put the revised main motion to the committee, and the votes were different.

05 **Nora:** Two yes, two no, and one abstention. I have the roll-call record alongside the exact revised wording, so we can verify both separately.

06 **Felix:** Under our stated rule, the [3] _____ is based on votes cast, not all seven members or all five present. Four votes were cast on each question.

07 **Nora:** So the amendment's three to one is enough. The main motion's two to two is not more than half. The pilot was not approved.

08 **Felix:** Correct. Record the [4] _____ accurately, but do not turn it into a third no. We still need the record to distinguish a tie from a two-to-three defeat.

09 **Nora:** The member who moved the pilot has asked whether the approved change leaves us with a three-month pilot automatically.

10 **Felix:** No. The change became part of the [5] _____. Its later defeat means the committee did not authorize that revised proposal.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The amendment passed; the proposal did not

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Nora:** I will correct the summary to show amendment adopted, then main motion as amended lost. I will not collapse the votes into one result.

12 **Felix:** Please retain the exact wording too. A reader should be able to tell that three months replaced six months, not that a separate three-month extension was authorized.

13 **Nora:** The draft currently labels the result unanimous. That is wrong even for the amendment, because one member voted against it.

14 **Felix:** Remove that. The [6] _____ gives us the actual responses. There is no need for a broader label that contradicts them.

15 **Nora:** For the public summary, I can say the committee amended the proposal but did not approve the pilot. That is shorter without changing the result.

16 **Felix:** That works. Keep the detailed voting record in the minutes according to our process. Plain language should clarify the outcome, not erase the separate decisions.

17 **Nora:** I will also remove the instruction to schedule the pilot. It appears to have been generated from the incorrect approval summary.

18 **Felix:** Good catch. Notify the program team of the corrected result before it relies on that instruction. The defeated motion does not authorize implementation.

19 **Nora:** I will circulate the corrected draft through the minutes-approval process and retain the revision history, rather than silently replacing an approved record.

20 **Felix:** Thank you. The final check is straightforward: five present, four voting each time, amendment three to one, main motion two to two, and no pilot approval.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. quorum / **2.** amendment / **3.** majority / **4.** abstention / **5.** main motion as amended / **6.** roll-call vote

Why these answers fit, page 167

Use the stated voting basis

A separate fictional board has six members present and a quorum requirement of five. A motion receives 3 yes, 2 no, and 1 abstention. Its rule requires more than half of votes cast, excluding abstentions.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

five / 5 / 3 / adopted

01 **Clerk:** The quorum requirement is [1] _____ members.

02 **Chair:** The number of votes actually cast is [2] _____.

03 **Clerk:** The number of affirmative votes is [3] _____.

04 **Chair:** Under this rule, the motion is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. five / **2.** 5 / **3.** 3 / **4.** adopted

Why these answers fit, page 167

Keep the distinction audible

Report the exact motion, voting basis, and outcome without confusing an amendment with the main decision.

Language for the next case

Unspent does not mean uncommitted

encumbrances

Encumbrances reserve budget for outstanding commitments under this report's basis; the 38,000 is not included in the 62,000 expenditure and is not freely available for new orders.

Elena: That ignores the encumbrances. Thirty-eight thousand is reserved for orders, leaving twenty thousand available before the final invoice.

appropriation

The appropriation is the stipulated 120,000 spending authority in this example; it is distinct from both money already spent and the department's bank balance.

Elena: Yes. From the appropriation of a hundred twenty thousand, subtract sixty-two thousand spent and thirty-eight thousand reserved, once each.

final invoice

The final invoice is the accepted 12,000 charge for the completed order; recording it uses twelve thousand of the amount previously reserved.

Elena: No. The final invoice uses twelve thousand of that reservation. Only the remaining three thousand becomes available when the unused amount is formally released.

budgetary basis

The budgetary basis defines how this report treats expenditure and outstanding reservations; using the same stipulated basis prevents double counting or mixing it with cash or financial-statement measures.

Elena: That confirmation matters. Under the stated budgetary basis, expenditure rises to seventy-four thousand and outstanding encumbrances fall to twenty-three thousand.

unencumbered balance

The unencumbered balance is the amount available after recorded expenditure and remaining reservations on this report's basis: 120,000 minus 74,000 minus 23,000 equals 23,000.

Elena: Exactly. The unencumbered balance increases by three thousand, not fifteen. The invoice replaced part of an existing reservation rather than creating a completely separate commitment.

release of encumbrance

A release of encumbrance removes budget reserved for an obligation no longer outstanding; it does not itself describe a cash receipt or supplier refund.

Elena: Right. A release of encumbrance changes budget availability. A cash receipt would need its own transaction and evidence.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Unspent does not mean uncommitted

Fictional budget report: appropriation $120,000; expenditure $62,000; separate outstanding encumbrances $38,000. An included order with $15,000 reserved is fully completed for a final accepted $12,000 invoice. The unused $3,000 is formally released and the order closed. No other changes apply. These figures use the stipulated reporting basis, not a universal accounting treatment.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

appropriation / unencumbered balance / budgetary basis / final invoice / release of encumbrance / encumbrances

01 **Ravi:** The report shows sixty-two thousand spent from a hundred twenty thousand. I was about to tell the team we have fifty-eight thousand left for new orders.

02 **Elena:** That ignores the [1] _____. Thirty-eight thousand is reserved for orders, leaving twenty thousand available before the final invoice.

03 **Ravi:** Let me put the authorized budget, expenditure, and outstanding commitments side by side. We need all three for this check.

04 **Elena:** Yes. From the [2] _____ of a hundred twenty thousand, subtract sixty-two thousand spent and thirty-eight thousand reserved, once each.

05 **Ravi:** One order has finished. We reserved fifteen thousand; the accepted final invoice is twelve. Does that free the entire fifteen?

06 **Elena:** No. The [3] _____ uses twelve thousand of that reservation. Only the remaining three thousand becomes available when the unused amount is formally released.

Conversation / continued

07 **Ravi:** The whole order is complete, with no remaining delivery or charge. We have that confirmation in the record.

08 **Elena:** That confirmation matters. Under the stated [4] _____, expenditure rises to seventy-four thousand and outstanding encumbrances fall to twenty-three thousand.

09 **Ravi:** That is sixty-two plus twelve, and thirty-eight less fifteen. Then a hundred twenty less seventy-four less twenty-three gives twenty-three thousand available.

10 **Elena:** Exactly. The [5] _____ increases by three thousand, not fifteen. The invoice replaced part of an existing reservation rather than creating a completely separate commitment.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Unspent does not mean uncommitted

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ravi:** Someone has already entered the twelve-thousand invoice in a local worksheet while leaving all thirty-eight thousand encumbered. That would understate what remains.

12 **Elena:** It would count the same twelve thousand as both expenditure and an outstanding reservation. Reconcile the worksheet to the controlled report and the completed order record.

13 **Ravi:** I will also avoid calling the released three thousand a cash refund. No supplier has paid anything back in these facts.

14 **Elena:** Right. A [6] _____ changes budget availability. A cash receipt would need its own transaction and evidence.

15 **Ravi:** Could we transfer the twenty-three thousand to a different program because the report now shows it available?

16 **Elena:** Not from this calculation alone. Available within this budget does not establish transfer authority. Any transfer or new commitment still follows the applicable budget and purchasing controls.

17 **Ravi:** Then I will show the revised balance and separately identify the proposed use. The arithmetic should not make the approval decision for us.

18 **Elena:** That is the right separation. Keep the appropriation, expenditure, remaining commitments, and calculation date visible so another reviewer can reproduce the result.

19 **Ravi:** My revised update is seventy-four thousand spent, twenty-three thousand still reserved, twenty-three thousand available, with the completed order formally closed.

20 **Elena:** Those figures reconcile to a hundred twenty thousand. Attach the final-invoice and release references so the next report does not restore the old reservation by mistake.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. encumbrances / **2.** appropriation / **3.** final invoice / **4.** budgetary basis / **5.** unencumbered balance / **6.** release of encumbrance

Why these answers fit, page 169

Close a fully completed order

Fictional report: $90,000 appropriation, $40,000 expenditure, and $35,000 separate outstanding encumbrances. An included $10,000 order is completed for a final $8,000. Its unused $2,000 is released and the order closed; no other changes occur.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

48 / 25 / 15 / 17

01 **Manager:** Before the final invoice, available budget is $[1] _____ thousand.

02 **Analyst:** Revised expenditure is $[2] _____ thousand.

03 **Manager:** Remaining encumbrances are $[3] _____ thousand.

04 **Analyst:** Revised available budget is $[4] _____ thousand.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 15 / **2.** 48 / **3.** 25 / **4.** 17

Why these answers fit, page 169

Keep the distinction audible

Reconcile available budget, outstanding commitments, and a final invoice without counting reserved funds twice.

Language for the next case

A notice residents can act on

supporting evidence

Supporting evidence is one of the three accepted address documents in this fictional process; the notice must not turn an alternative list into a requirement to supply all three.

Omar: The supporting evidence is a single accepted address document. We also need the signed renewal form, so there are two required items in the submission.

one of

One of expresses an alternative choice among the listed documents; it prevents the three acceptable options from becoming three cumulative requirements.

Omar: Keep one of prominent. A utility bill, tenancy agreement, or council letter is acceptable under the stated process. We should not add documents that the policy does not list.

received by

Received by makes arrival the deadline condition; merely sending or postmarking the submission before the cutoff does not satisfy this fictional process.

Omar: Write received by twenty-four October at 17:00 local time. Both the form and the selected document must arrive by that cutoff.

submission routes

Submission routes identify the authorized ways to provide the material: the renewal portal or Service Desk; simplifying the notice must not remove an available route.

Omar: Yes. Those are the two stated submission routes. Do not replace them with online only just because the portal link is convenient to print.

active voice

Active voice makes the actor and action explicit, as in Submit your signed renewal form; it improves clarity without altering what the process requires.

Omar: Use active voice. We can speak directly to the resident while keeping the required documents and deadline exact.

receipt confirmation

Receipt confirmation shows that a submission arrived and provides its reference; it does not establish completeness, eligibility, or approval of the renewal.

Omar: Change it to receipt confirmation. The team still checks the application. The reference is useful for an inquiry, but it is not an approval notice.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

A notice residents can act on

Fictional allotment-renewal notice R18: the signed renewal form must arrive with ONE of three listed address documents: a current utility bill, tenancy agreement, or council letter. Both items must be received by 24 October at 17:00 local time, through the renewal portal or Service Desk. A postmark is insufficient. A reference number confirms receipt only. The proposed shorter notice wrongly says send all documents by 24 October.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

active voice / one of / submission routes / supporting evidence / received by / receipt confirmation

01 **Mae:** The shorter version is easier to read, but it changes what residents have to do. Send all documents is not equivalent to one document from this list.

02 **Omar:** The [1] _____ is a single accepted address document. We also need the signed renewal form, so there are two required items in the submission.

03 **Mae:** Then let us separate the instruction from the choices. Submit your signed renewal form and one of the following address documents. The list can sit immediately below.

04 **Omar:** Keep [2] _____ prominent. A utility bill, tenancy agreement, or council letter is acceptable under the stated process. We should not add documents that the policy does not list.

05 **Mae:** The deadline sentence also lost the time. Someone reading by twenty-four October might reasonably assume they have until midnight.

06 **Omar:** Write [3] _____ twenty-four October at 17:00 local time. Both the form and the selected document must arrive by that cutoff.

Conversation / continued

07 **Mae:** I will put that near the action, not in a footer. Do we still accept both the renewal portal and the Service Desk?

08 **Omar:** Yes. Those are the two stated [4] _____. Do not replace them with online only just because the portal link is convenient to print.

09 **Mae:** I also want the sentence to name who receives the material. Your renewal form must be submitted hides the action and makes the next step less immediate.

10 **Omar:** Use [5] _____. We can speak directly to the resident while keeping the required documents and deadline exact.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A notice residents can act on

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Mae:** Below the portal link, the draft says a reference number means renewal approved. That is not supported by the intake process.

12 **Omar:** Change it to [6] _____. The team still checks the application. The reference is useful for an inquiry, but it is not an approval notice.

13 **Mae:** Could we test the new version with the service team by asking them to identify the two required items, deadline, and available routes?

14 **Omar:** Yes. Give them the notice rather than explaining it first. If they select all three address documents, the wording or layout still needs work.

15 **Mae:** I will also ask them whether a twenty-fourth-of-October postmark is enough. The correct answer under these instructions is no; arrival is what matters.

16 **Omar:** And ask what the reference number establishes. Those checks cover the errors residents would actually encounter, rather than whether colleagues merely like the shorter text.

17 **Mae:** The revised version will use a short document list, a separate deadline line, and labeled submission routes. The contact details will remain with the notice.

18 **Omar:** Keep R18 visible too. Staff need to identify the version a resident received if an older copy is still circulating.

19 **Mae:** I will send the revised wording for process-owner approval before publication. Clearer wording is still a change that must match the current requirements.

20 **Omar:** Agreed. The final check is signed form plus one accepted address document, received by the exact cutoff, through either stated route, with receipt distinguished from approval.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. supporting evidence / **2.** one of / **3.** received by / **4.** submission routes / **5.** active voice / **6.** receipt confirmation

Why these answers fit, page 171

Check a second notice

Fictional notice S20 requires a signed application plus ONE of a current lease or accepted council letter. Both must be received by 6 November at 16:00 local time. The reference confirms receipt, not approval.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

application / receipt / one / 16:00

01 **Editor:** The applicant chooses [1] _____ of the two address documents.

02 **Officer:** The chosen document accompanies the signed [2] _____.

03 **Editor:** Both items must arrive by [3] _____ local time on 6 November.

04 **Officer:** The reference number confirms [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. one / **2.** application / **3.** 16:00 / **4.** receipt

Why these answers fit, page 171

> **Keep the distinction audible**
>
> Replace administrative jargon with clear instructions while preserving the exact document choices, deadline, and submission route.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which document explains the current requirements?

C. Guidance G4

G4 is identified as the published guidance explaining the current program requirements.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. What does P2 propose?

B. Reducing the residence period to six months

P2 proposes a six-month residence period, but adoption and an effective date are absent.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What can Theo accurately say about nine months?

D. It is below the current 12-month residence condition.

Nine months is shorter than the current residence condition, but the desk conversation is not a formal determination.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which explanation is accurate?

B. P2 proposes six months; G4 still describes the current twelve-month condition.

The accurate explanation preserves both document status and the current versus proposed periods.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. Which response avoids an unauthorized decision?

A. Nine months is below the current condition; I can explain the formal review process.

The response explains the stated condition without issuing a decision or inventing authority.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A suggested change that has not necessarily been adopted. Which term fits?

C. proposal

A Not here. transition provision: A rule addressing movement from an old arrangement to a new one. The usual combination is "check transition provisions".

B Not here. comment deadline: The closing time for input under a specified process. The usual combination is "verify the comment deadline".

C Correct. proposal: A suggested change that has not necessarily been adopted. The usual combination is "distinguish the proposal".

D Not here. verification: Checking information against appropriate evidence. The usual combination is "complete verification".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The proposal has not changed the current application test". Amina: "Does the date at the top of P2 mean the shorter period started then?" Theo: [missing response] Amina: "So my nine months does not meet the condition you are using at the moment?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. That is the publication date, not an effective date. No effective date has been established for this proposal. We should not tell applicants that the six-month condition already applies.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Amina says: "Thank you. Please show me where the current application steps are, and I will read the proposal notice separately." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Theo's response in turn 6. It connects Amina's preceding point with Amina's follow-up. Effective date identifies when a measure applies; P2 has no such date because the proposed change is not adopted.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Amina says: "I would like to support the change. Is submitting a comment the same as asking to receive the grant?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Amina says: "If the proposal is adopted later, should I assume it will apply to every application already on file?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. proposal

Turn 2. Proposal identifies P2 as a suggested change, not an adopted replacement for the current program condition.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. current guidance

Turn 4. Current guidance is G4, the identified explanation of the presently applicable program requirements.

3. effective date

Turn 6. Effective date identifies when a measure applies; P2 has no such date because the proposed change is not adopted.

4. residence requirement

Turn 8. Residence requirement is the stated twelve-month condition; nine months is below it without resolving every other eligibility question.

5. eligibility determination

Turn 10. Eligibility determination is an authorized qualification decision, which this information conversation does not issue.

6. eligibility criterion

Turn 12. Eligibility criterion is one condition within the program's test; meeting it alone would not establish entitlement to an award.

7. transition provision

Turn 14. Transition provision governs movement between arrangements; future application treatment cannot be invented before the adopted terms are known.

8. public comment

Turn 16. Public comment contributes to consultation on the proposal; it is separate from applying for an individual program benefit.

9. adoption

Turn 18. Adoption is formal acceptance through the applicable process; publication of a proposal alone does not establish it.

10. application intake

Turn 20. Application intake is the process of receiving a program application, distinct from giving information or collecting consultation comments.

Return to the conversation, page 10

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What should Theo check before describing a change as operative?

A. Its adoption, applicable terms, and effective date

Publication, a website link, or the end of consultation alone does not make the proposal operative; adoption and applicability must be checked.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F2. Which statement keeps the processes distinct?

C. Commenting on P2 does not itself submit an application for the grant.

Consultation input and a program application have different purposes and must not be conflated.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F / Guided speaking

1. H3

Officer: The current guidance is H3.

Turn 1. H3 is explicitly identified as the document stating the presently applicable condition.

2. eight months

Resident: The current residence condition is eight months.

Turn 2. Eight months is current; four months belongs to the unadopted proposal.

3. not adopted

Officer: The proposal's status is not adopted.

Turn 3. Q1 has not been adopted, so its proposed period cannot replace the current condition.

4. not been made

Resident: A formal application decision has not been made.

Turn 4. The record expressly says that no formal determination has been issued.

Return to the conversation, page 13

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The proposal has not changed the current application test". Amina: "If the proposal is adopted later, should I assume it will apply to every application already on file?" Theo: [missing response] Amina: "I would like to support the change. Is submitting a comment the same as asking to receive the grant?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. We would need to read any transition provision in the adopted measure. We cannot invent how pending applications would be handled before the actual terms and dates are available.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Amina says: "Thank you. Please show me where the current application steps are, and I will read the proposal notice separately." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Amina says: "Does the date at the top of P2 mean the shorter period started then?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Theo's response in turn 14. It connects Amina's preceding point with Amina's follow-up. Transition provision governs movement between arrangements; future application treatment cannot be invented before the adopted terms are known.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Amina says: "I would like to support the change. Is submitting a comment the same as asking to receive the grant?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 13

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Who should be called next under the announced process?

C. The next registered speaker who has not had an initial turn

Five registered speakers remain unheard, and the announced process gives initial turns before second turns.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A2. What is the written-submission deadline?

A. Friday at 17:00 local time

The brief expressly states the Friday local-time deadline for written input.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A3. What is this meeting's purpose?

C. To gather input, not decide the proposal by a public vote

The stated consultation purpose is collecting input rather than holding an up-or-down vote.

Return to the exercise, page 14

D / Response choices

D1. Which intervention best follows the process?

A. Thank you; we will hear the remaining initial speakers before returning to second turns.

The intervention applies the announced priority without favoring a viewpoint or canceling unheard contributions.

Return to the exercise, page 18

D2. Which record entry is appropriately attributed?

B. A speaker reported concerns about evening access.

Attribution preserves the reported concern without converting one contribution into verified or universal evidence.

Return to the exercise, page 18

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The person maintaining meeting records and administrative arrangements. Which term fits?

B. meeting clerk

A Not here. interpretation: Spoken or signed language conversion supporting understanding. The usual combination is "arrange interpretation".

B Correct. meeting clerk: The person maintaining meeting records and administrative arrangements. The usual combination is "brief the meeting clerk".

C Not here. second turn: A later speaking opportunity after an initial contribution. The usual combination is "allow second turns".

D Not here. submission deadline: The final time for receiving input under the process. The usual combination is "state the submission deadline".

Return to the exercise, page 18

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Give the next speaker a fair turn". Rosa: "One supports the proposal and the other opposes it. We need to make clear that this is not about either position." Ian: [missing response] Rosa: "Could we promise them another opportunity at the end, so they are less frustrated now?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. That is viewpoint neutrality. Apply the same initial-turn rule and the same announced three-minute allocation. The explanation should focus on process, not agreement with their arguments.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Rosa says: "I heard their concerns. Now I need to move the meeting on without making it sound as though disagreement costs someone a turn." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Rosa says: "The clerk's summary says that residents cannot reach the site in the evening. Only one person has made that claim so far." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Ian's response in turn 6. It connects Rosa's preceding point with Rosa's follow-up. Viewpoint neutrality applies the participation process consistently to supporters and opponents rather than favoring a position.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Rosa says: "Please remind me of the exact deadline. I do not want to give two different times in the same meeting." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 18

E / Conversation

1. initial turn

Turn 2. Initial turn is the first speaking opportunity, which the announced process gives priority over repeat contributions.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. procedural reminder

Turn 4. Procedural reminder restates the announced turn-taking rule without criticizing the substance or intensity of a contribution.

3. viewpoint neutrality

Turn 6. Viewpoint neutrality applies the participation process consistently to supporters and opponents rather than favoring a position.

4. second turn

Turn 8. Second turn is a later opportunity after initial contributions; it should not be guaranteed before the announced priority is met.

5. submission deadline

Turn 10. Submission deadline is Friday at 17:00 local time, the announced cutoff for written input in this fictional meeting.

6. consultation

Turn 12. Consultation gathers input for a decision process; applause and speaker counts are not a binding public ballot here.

7. attribution

Turn 14. Attribution identifies the speaker as the source, avoiding conversion of an individual report into a verified community-wide finding.

8. accessibility arrangement

Turn 16. Accessibility arrangement supports participation through the stated process; it should not be dismissed as a viewpoint-based request for influence.

9. meeting record

Turn 18. Meeting record preserves the contributions and procedural actions so the later decision process has an accurate account.

10. decision authority

Turn 20. Decision authority identifies the body empowered to decide, separating receipt of public input from approval of the proposal.

Return to the conversation, page 20

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. How should an access request be handled?

C. Through the announced accessibility arrangements

Consistent treatment includes the stated access process; identical format, counting the request as a contribution, or delaying support may prevent participation.

Return to the exercise, page 23

F2. Which explanation correctly describes the meeting?

D. It gathers input for the designated decision process.

The consultation collects input but does not transfer decision authority to applause or individual submissions.

Return to the exercise, page 23

F / Guided speaking

1. two minutes

Chair: The initial speaking allocation is two minutes.

Turn 1. The announced process assigns two minutes to each initial contribution.

2. three

Clerk: The number of registered people still unheard is three.

Turn 2. Three people remain entitled to the next initial turns under the stated process.

3. Wednesday at 12:00 local time

Chair: Written input closes Wednesday at 12:00 local time.

Turn 3. The deadline includes the day, time, and local-time reference from the announcement.

4. consultation

Clerk: The session is a consultation.

Turn 4. The session gathers input rather than determining the outcome through a public ballot.

Return to the conversation, page 24

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Give the next speaker a fair turn". Rosa: "The clerk's summary says that residents cannot reach the site in the evening. Only one person has made that claim so far." Ian: [missing response] Rosa: "Another participant has asked for an adjustment so they can follow and contribute to the discussion. How should I respond?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Keep the attribution. Record that a speaker reported an evening-access concern. We can preserve the point without turning it into a verified finding about every resident.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Rosa says: "I heard their concerns. Now I need to move the meeting on without making it sound as though disagreement costs someone a turn." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Ian's response in turn 14. It connects Rosa's preceding point with Rosa's follow-up. Attribution identifies the speaker as the source, avoiding conversion of an individual report into a verified community-wide finding.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Rosa says: "Please remind me of the exact deadline. I do not want to give two different times in the same meeting." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Rosa says: "One supports the proposal and the other opposes it. We need to make clear that this is not about either position." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What are the recorded totals?

A. A has 86 and B has 82.

Adding the three recorded weighted scores produces totals of eighty-six and eighty-two.

Return to the exercise, page 27

A2. What is A's price premium?

B. $10,000

A's price of one hundred twenty thousand exceeds B's one hundred ten thousand by ten thousand.

Return to the exercise, page 27

A3. Which consideration is not a published criterion?

A. The vendor's local address

The brief lists three published factors and expressly excludes local address as a criterion.

Return to the exercise, page 27

D / Response choices

D1. Which evaluation note is strongest?

C. Link A's scored strengths to proposal evidence and explain the $10,000 premium.

The strongest note connects the comparative benefits, evidence, and cost under the published method.

Return to the exercise, page 31

D2. What should happen to the existing weighted scores?

D. Check their arithmetic without applying the weights again.

The scores are already weighted, so a second weighting would distort the recorded method.

Return to the exercise, page 31

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A stated dimension used to assess proposals. Which term fits?

D. evaluation factor

A Not here. weakness: An assessed unfavorable feature under an evaluation criterion. The usual combination is "document a weakness".

B Not here. conflict of interest: An interest that may improperly influence, or appear to influence, official judgment. The usual combination is "disclose a conflict of interest".

C Not here. technical approach: The proposed method for delivering the required work. The usual combination is "evaluate the technical approach".

D Correct. evaluation factor: A stated dimension used to assess proposals. The usual combination is "apply the evaluation factors".

Return to the exercise, page 31

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Best value needs a reason, not just a label". Marta: "A is also ten thousand dollars more expensive. The note cannot simply report the higher total and leave that difference unexplained." Dev: [missing response] Marta: "Which features support the technical difference? A reader should not have to infer a benefit from the score alone." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Agreed. The price premium is part of the decision. A costs one hundred twenty thousand, while B costs one hundred ten thousand. Our method permits a documented trade-off.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Marta says: "Someone suggested mentioning that A's office is local. Does the solicitation give us a factor for that?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Marta says: "Good. Keep the published criteria, the verified totals, the evidence, and the premium visible in the revised note." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 6. It connects Marta's preceding point with Marta's follow-up. Price premium is the ten-thousand-dollar difference between the two quoted prices, which the trade-off reasoning must address.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Marta says: "That gives eighty-six and eighty-two. Are those raw marks that still need the fifty, thirty, and twenty weighting applied?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 31

E / Conversation

1. scoring matrix

Turn 2. Scoring matrix records each proposal's assessment against the stated factors, allowing the totals and differences to be checked.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. weighted score

Turn 4. Weighted score already incorporates the specified importance; applying the weights again would change the method and distort the totals.

3. price premium

Turn 6. Price premium is the ten-thousand-dollar difference between the two quoted prices, which the trade-off reasoning must address.

4. evaluation narrative

Turn 8. Evaluation narrative supplies the reasons and evidence behind scores rather than relying on a numerical total alone.

5. evaluation factor

Turn 10. Evaluation factor is a published assessment dimension; local address is not one of the stated criteria here.

6. trade-off

Turn 12. Trade-off compares the assessed benefits with the additional cost under the permitted method, retaining both favorable and unfavorable evidence.

7. Best value

Turn 14. Best value is the most advantageous result under the applicable selection method, not a universal consequence of a score or price.

8. conflict of interest

Turn 16. Conflict of interest concerns an interest that could influence official judgment; it requires the applicable disclosure and review process.

9. award authority

Turn 18. Award authority is the empowered decision-maker; the evaluation team's recommendation does not itself authorize or execute an award.

10. audit trail

Turn 20. Audit trail links the conclusion to the criteria, evidence, arithmetic, and approvals, allowing later review of the decision.

Return to the conversation, page 33

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which statement preserves authority?

A. The evaluation recommends A; the award decision remains pending.

The brief gives the evaluation team a recommendation role while award authorization remains outstanding.

Return to the exercise, page 36

F2. Which challenge is appropriate?

B. Which published factor and submitted evidence support that claimed strength?

The challenge tests the rationale within the stated rules instead of changing them to fit a desired result.

Return to the exercise, page 36

F / Guided speaking

1. 85

Evaluator: C's total weighted score is 85.

Turn 1. Forty-two plus twenty-six plus seventeen equals eighty-five without applying weights again.

2. 84

Officer: D's total weighted score is 84.

Turn 2. Forty plus twenty-five plus nineteen equals eighty-four under the supplied scoring record.

3. $5,000

Evaluator: C's price premium is $5,000.

Turn 3. Seventy-five thousand minus seventy thousand gives a five-thousand-dollar premium.

4. approval pending

Officer: The award status is approval pending.

Turn 4. The stated approval has not occurred, so a score comparison does not itself award the contract.

Return to the conversation, page 37

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Best value needs a reason, not just a label". Marta: "Is a four-point lead sufficient by itself? The summary says highest score therefore award, which skips the trade-off we have just discussed." Dev: [missing response] Marta: "Before circulation, check that any interests affecting an evaluator have gone through the proper disclosure process." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. No. Best value depends on this selection method and a defensible record. We should not present our scoring example as a rule for every procurement.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Marta says: "I can check the totals, but I cannot sign this rationale yet. Best value is doing a lot of work in the draft. Show me what sits behind it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 14. It connects Marta's preceding point with Marta's follow-up. Best value is the most advantageous result under the applicable selection method, not a universal consequence of a score or price.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Marta says: "That gives eighty-six and eighty-two. Are those raw marks that still need the fifty, thirty, and twenty weighting applied?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Marta says: "We also need to show that B's stronger price result was recognized, not quietly removed because the team prefers A." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 37

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What total do the assembled supporting records substantiate?

B. $47,000

Twenty-nine thousand plus twelve thousand plus six thousand equals forty-seven thousand.

Return to the exercise, page 38

A2. Where is the evidence gap?

A. A $1,000 personnel item

The personnel report exceeds the assembled personnel support by one thousand dollars.

Return to the exercise, page 38

A3. What conclusion is not established by the difference alone?

B. Fraud or cost allowability

The discrepancy identifies missing support but does not determine intent or whether the cost is allowable.

Return to the exercise, page 38

D / Response choices

D1. Which reconciliation statement is correct?

D. Reported expenditure is $48,000; assembled support is $47,000, with $1,000 unresolved in personnel.

The category sum is correct, but one personnel item lacks its requested supporting record.

Return to the exercise, page 42

D2. What should Owen do first with the specific gap?

A. Trace the personnel item and seek the missing support.

Tracing the identified item addresses the actual evidence gap without inventing treatment or intent.

Return to the exercise, page 42

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An entity providing a subaward from funding it has received. Which term fits?

C. pass-through entity

A Not here. unsupported item: An item lacking the evidence required for the stated review. The usual combination is "flag an unsupported item".

B Not here. unobligated balance: Funds not committed through obligations under the applicable accounting basis. The usual combination is "report the unobligated balance".

C Correct. pass-through entity: An entity providing a subaward from funding it has received. The usual combination is "contact the pass-through entity".

D Not here. personnel cost: Cost associated with staff work under the applicable accounting rules. The usual combination is "document personnel costs".

Return to the exercise, page 42

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence". Sana: "Then the issue is not that the spreadsheet added the categories incorrectly. It is that the evidence does not yet support every reported item." Owen: [missing response] Sana: "Someone suggested moving the thousand into travel because that category has room in the budget. That would make the report look less awkward." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Correct. The reconciliation should show forty-eight thousand reported, forty-seven thousand supported, and one thousand unresolved in personnel. That is the clearest description of the current position.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Sana says: "The records I have show twenty-nine thousand for personnel. Materials and travel match the schedule. Is there another personnel record somewhere?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Sana says: "Before comparing the figures again, please confirm that we are using the same quarter and the same accounting basis." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 6. It connects Sana's preceding point with Sana's follow-up. Reconciliation compares the report with supporting records and identifies the precise difference rather than concealing it in the total.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Sana says: "I cannot tie G62 to the evidence folder. The report says forty-eight thousand; I can support forty-seven. Can we work through the category totals together?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 42

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04 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. supporting schedule

Turn 2. Supporting schedule breaks down the total into categories so the reported amount can be compared with the corresponding evidence.

2. source documentation

Turn 4. Source documentation substantiates the transaction; the requested record for one personnel item is absent from the assembled evidence.

3. reconciliation

Turn 6. Reconciliation compares the report with supporting records and identifies the precise difference rather than concealing it in the total.

4. budget category

Turn 8. Budget category should reflect the transaction's proper classification, not a convenient place to hide an unsupported amount.

5. unsupported item

Turn 10. Unsupported item accurately describes the missing required evidence without asserting fraudulent intent or a final cost decision.

6. Allowable cost

Turn 12. Allowable cost depends on the governing rules and award terms; finding a record alone does not decide that status.

7. reporting period

Turn 14. Reporting period defines the interval covered by the report; mismatched periods can create misleading differences in a reconciliation.

8. certification

Turn 16. Certification is an authorized attestation; an unresolved required evidence gap must not be hidden when completeness is attested.

9. corrected report

Turn 18. Corrected report records an authorized revision; the original amount, reason, and approval should remain traceable.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. variance

Turn 20. Variance is the one-thousand-dollar difference between reported and supported figures; it remains visible until an evidenced treatment resolves it.

Return to the conversation, page 44

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which statement about allowability is sound?

B. It requires review under the applicable rules and award terms.

Evidence and correct arithmetic matter, but cost allowability also depends on the governing requirements.

Return to the exercise, page 48

F2. What should a correction preserve?

C. A traceable record of the original figure, reason, approval, and revised treatment

A documented correction lets reviewers understand what changed, why, and under whose authority.

Return to the exercise, page 48

F / Guided speaking

1. $28,000

Officer: The reported total is $28,000.

Turn 1. Eighteen thousand plus seven thousand plus three thousand equals twenty-eight thousand.

2. $27,500

Coordinator: The supported total is $27,500.

Turn 2. Eighteen thousand plus six thousand five hundred plus three thousand equals twenty-seven thousand five hundred.

3. $500

Officer: The unresolved difference is $500.

Turn 3. The reported total exceeds the assembled support by five hundred dollars.

4. materials

Coordinator: The affected category is materials.

Turn 4. Personnel and travel match their support; the five-hundred-dollar difference is in materials.

Return to the conversation, page 49

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence". Sana: "Before comparing the figures again, please confirm that we are using the same quarter and the same accounting basis." Owen: [missing response] Sana: "The submission includes a completeness certification. I do not want us to sign it while ignoring a required missing record." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will check the reporting period and the award reference. We should not reconcile a current-quarter total against a folder containing a different period and then explain the wrong discrepancy.

A Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 14. It connects Sana's preceding point with Sana's follow-up. Reporting period defines the interval covered by the report; mismatched periods can create misleading differences in a reconciliation.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Sana says: "If a correction is authorized, keep the original report and the reason for the change. We need a clear history." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Sana says: "The submission includes a completeness certification. I do not want us to sign it while ignoring a required missing record." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Sana says: "The draft issue note calls it fraud. All we know so far is that the record is missing. I want the wording to reflect that distinction." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 49

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Who owns the resident update?

B. Jon at 15:00 local time

Jon explicitly accepts responsibility for the resident update at the stated local time.

Return to the exercise, page 52

A2. What will Transit provide by 14:30?

D. An availability status to Jon

Aisha commits to sending a status on availability, not approving eligibility or guaranteeing a booking.

Return to the exercise, page 52

A3. What remains unconfirmed?

A. Eligibility and the transport booking

The offices have assigned communication tasks, but neither the eligibility decision nor booking is confirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 52

D / Response choices

D1. Which handoff is complete?

C. Aisha sends the availability status by 14:30; Jon confirms receipt and updates the resident at 15:00.

The complete handoff names actions, recipients, timing, and confirmation without claiming service approval.

Return to the exercise, page 56

D2. Which statement preserves the agencies' roles?

D. Community reviews eligibility; Transit checks availability.

The brief assigns these distinct responsibilities and leaves both substantive outcomes open.

Return to the exercise, page 56

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The office to which a matter is transferred. Which term fits?

B. receiving office

A Not here. joint status: A coordinated account of progress across participating teams. The usual combination is "prepare a joint status".

B Correct. receiving office: The office to which a matter is transferred. The usual combination is "confirm the receiving office".

C Not here. pickup zone: The defined area from which a transport pickup is requested. The usual combination is "confirm the pickup zone".

D Not here. acceptance of responsibility: Confirmation that a person or team has taken ownership of a task. The usual combination is "record acceptance of responsibility".

Return to the exercise, page 56

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Everyone is involved, but nobody has called the resident". Jon: "Is that a booking confirmation, or simply the result of the availability check at that point?" Aisha: [missing response] Jon: "Community still needs to complete its program review. I do not want either team to imply that the transport request itself establishes eligibility." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. It is an availability check status. We have not confirmed a vehicle or a booking. I will distinguish available, unavailable, and still under review rather than use the vague word arranged.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Jon says: "If you still cannot confirm availability at 14:30, please tell me that rather than wait until you have a final answer." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Aisha's response in turn 6. It connects Jon's preceding point with Jon's follow-up. Availability check assesses resources; it does not automatically confirm a reservation or a completed journey.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Jon says: "That is where we lost the thread last time. Sent appeared in the record, and everyone read it as taken over. I will separate those statuses." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Jon says: "Let me read it back: you send the availability status by 14:30; I own the resident update at 15:00. Eligibility and booking remain unconfirmed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 56

E / Conversation

1. lead contact

Turn 2. Lead contact identifies who coordinates resident communication, resolving the earlier ambiguity between offices.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. action owner

Turn 4. Action owner assigns Aisha the Transit status task, distinct from Jon's resident update.

3. availability check

Turn 6. Availability check assesses resources; it does not automatically confirm a reservation or a completed journey.

4. eligibility review

Turn 8. Eligibility review remains Community's task; coordination assignments do not decide whether the resident qualifies.

5. request reference

Turn 10. Request reference links the offices' records to Q41 without repeating unnecessary personal information.

6. secure channel

Turn 12. Secure channel is the approved route for this authorized exchange, preserving safeguards while the two offices coordinate.

7. acknowledgment of receipt

Turn 14. Acknowledgment of receipt confirms arrival, not task ownership; acceptance must also be explicit.

8. joint status

Turn 16. Joint status combines both offices' progress and open questions without implying completed decisions.

9. escalation contact

Turn 18. Escalation contact provides a named route for unresolved coordination issues, preventing another round of unowned messages.

10. closed-loop handoff

Turn 20. Closed-loop handoff confirms receipt, ownership, and next actions instead of relying on message delivery alone.

Return to the conversation, page 58

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which information belongs in the authorized initial exchange?

B. Request reference, pickup zone, and requested window

The defined initial task needs the specified limited information, not unnecessary sensitive records.

Return to the exercise, page 61

F2. What should happen if availability remains unknown at 14:30?

D. Aisha sends that status and the open question so Jon can give the promised update.

A progress update remains useful and due even when the underlying resource decision is incomplete.

Return to the exercise, page 61

F / Guided speaking

1. Bea

Coordinator: The internal status owner is Bea.

Turn 1. Bea is assigned to send Mobility's availability status to Eli.

2. 10:00

Officer: The internal update deadline is 10:00.

Turn 2. This deadline precedes the resident update and gives Eli the information needed for that contact.

3. Eli

Coordinator: The resident-contact owner is Eli.

Turn 3. Eli owns communication with the resident, distinct from Bea's availability task.

4. 10:30 local time

Officer: The resident update is at 10:30 local time.

Turn 4. The supplied resident-contact commitment includes the exact time and its local-time reference.

Return to the conversation, page 62

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Everyone is involved, but nobody has called the resident". Jon: "That is where we lost the thread last time. Sent appeared in the record, and everyone read it as taken over. I will separate those statuses." Aisha: [missing response] Jon: "If you still cannot confirm availability at 14:30, please tell me that rather than wait until you have a final answer." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. An acknowledgment of receipt alone would not show ownership. I will record the next action and its deadline so your team can see what I have actually agreed to do.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Jon says: "Is that a booking confirmation, or simply the result of the availability check at that point?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Jon says: "Let me read it back: you send the availability status by 14:30; I own the resident update at 15:00. Eligibility and booking remain unconfirmed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Aisha's response in turn 14. It connects Jon's preceding point with Jon's follow-up. Acknowledgment of receipt confirms arrival, not task ownership; acceptance must also be explicit.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Jon says: "If you still cannot confirm availability at 14:30, please tell me that rather than wait until you have a final answer." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 62

06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which office receives the site plan under this process?

D. Public Works Permit Intake

The brief expressly assigns receipt and routing of sidewalk-use applications to Public Works Permit Intake.

Return to the exercise, page 63

A2. What is Ben's Wednesday 10:00 commitment?

A. A follow-up call about the referral

Ben promises a status call, not an application outcome or completion of every review step.

Return to the exercise, page 63

A3. How should the redirection complaint be recorded?

D. Separately from the permit application

The complaint concerns service handling and should not be confused with the separate permit decision.

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D / Response choices

D1. Which explanation gives a useful referral?

B. Licensing handles registration; Public Works Permit Intake receives the sidewalk application and site plan.

The explanation names the responsible function and required intake item without promising permission.

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D2. Which follow-up statement is accurate?

C. I will call Wednesday at 10:00 local time with the referral status.

Ben can promise a status contact, while acceptance and substantive decisions remain unconfirmed.

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06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The unit receiving and initially routing requests or applications. Which term fits?

D. intake office

A Not here. service history: The record of contacts and actions concerning a service matter. The usual combination is "review the service history".

B Not here. substantive review: Assessment of the application's merits against the relevant requirements. The usual combination is "await substantive review".

C Not here. complaint reference: An identifier for a complaint record. The usual combination is "provide the complaint reference".

D Correct. intake office: The unit receiving and initially routing requests or applications. The usual combination is "identify the intake office".

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D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A referral that does not send the resident in circles". Tessa: "I have a drawing showing where the bench would go and how much space would remain. Is that the document they need first?" Ben: [missing response] Tessa: "Can you transfer the information I have already given? I do not want to start the story again with a fourth person." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. The stated intake item is a site plan. I can confirm their submission requirements, but I should not say your drawing is complete or approved before the receiving team checks it.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Tessa says: "Does that mean I will have a permit decision by Wednesday morning, or only information about where the application stands?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Tessa says: "I also want the repeated redirection recorded as a complaint. That has cost time even if the permit process still has work to do." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 6. It connects Tessa's preceding point with Tessa's follow-up. Site plan shows the proposed location and layout for the permit process, rather than proving that the proposal is already approved.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Tessa says: "Then I will expect your Wednesday call about the referral, and the complaint will follow its own review route." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 67

E / Conversation

1. service remit

Turn 2. Service remit identifies what each office handles, explaining the referral rather than merely redirecting the resident.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. sidewalk-use permit

Turn 4. Sidewalk-use permit concerns this town's public-space permission, which business registration alone does not provide.

3. site plan

Turn 6. Site plan shows the proposed location and layout for the permit process, rather than proving that the proposal is already approved.

4. case summary

Turn 8. Case summary preserves the issue and contact history, reducing unnecessary repetition for the resident.

5. Referral acceptance

Turn 10. Referral acceptance confirms that the receiving office has taken the matter; a sent message alone does not establish this.

6. follow-up call

Turn 12. Follow-up call is a timed status contact within Ben's control, not a deadline for granting the permit.

7. decision deadline

Turn 14. Decision deadline is a separate requirement of the permit process; Ben's call commitment does not create or replace it.

8. service complaint

Turn 16. Service complaint addresses the handling experience; it should not be treated as an application, an approval, or a reason for refusal.

9. case continuity

Turn 18. Case continuity preserves relevant history while keeping the complaint and permit application distinguishable.

10. closure reason

Turn 20. Closure reason explains the actual outcome; an unaccepted referral does not establish resolution.

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06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What preserves case continuity?

A. An authorized relevant summary and confirmation of the receiving contact

A relevant, authorized handoff reduces repetition while retaining ownership and appropriate information limits.

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F2. How should the complaint affect the permit decision?

A. It should be handled separately, without pre-deciding the permit.

The service complaint concerns handling, not whether the proposed sidewalk use meets permit requirements.

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F / Guided speaking

1. Road Use Intake

Resident: The office receiving the banner plan is Road Use Intake.

Turn 1. The local process assigns banner-plan receipt to Road Use Intake, not Events Registration.

2. Hana

Officer: The promised follow-up owner is Hana.

Turn 2. Hana is the named officer who commits to the referral-status call.

3. Thursday at 14:00 local time

Resident: The call is scheduled for Thursday at 14:00 local time.

Turn 3. The stated contact includes the day, time, and local-time reference.

4. referral status

Officer: The call concerns referral status.

Turn 4. The promise is to report the referral position, not to guarantee a permit decision.

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06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A referral that does not send the resident in circles". Tessa: "Does that mean I will have a permit decision by Wednesday morning, or only information about where the application stands?" Ben: [missing response] Tessa: "I also want the repeated redirection recorded as a complaint. That has cost time even if the permit process still has work to do." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Only the status update. A decision deadline for the permit has not been established here. Receipt, completeness review, and substantive review are different stages, and I cannot collapse them into that call.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Tessa says: "Can you transfer the information I have already given? I do not want to start the story again with a fourth person." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Tessa says: "I have explained this bench three times. Licensing sent me elsewhere, and I was sent back. Before I join another queue, can someone tell me who actually handles it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 14. It connects Tessa's preceding point with Tessa's follow-up. Decision deadline is a separate requirement of the permit process; Ben's call commitment does not create or replace it.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Tessa says: "I have a drawing showing where the bench would go and how much space would remain. Is that the document they need first?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 73

07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What has been established?

D. Eight responsive contract files have been located.

The search located eight responsive files, but the release review has not reached a decision.

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A2. What needs correction?

A. The promise of automatic full release

The acknowledgment overpromises disclosure before the required review of potentially protected information.

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A3. What follows from personal details appearing in two files?

C. Those details require review; full-file withholding is not automatic.

Potentially protected details call for the applicable review, including consideration of releasable portions.

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D / Response choices

D1. Which update is accurate?

A. Eight responsive files were located; disclosure review remains underway.

The update reports the completed search step while preserving the unresolved disclosure decision.

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D2. How should the earlier acknowledgment be handled?

A. Correct the automatic-release promise and explain the actual review status.

The requester needs an explicit correction and actual status; silence, premature withholding, or an unexplained replacement leaves the error unresolved.

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07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A record falling within the request's description. Which term fits?

C. responsive record

A Not here. acknowledgment: A response confirming receipt of a request. The usual combination is "issue an acknowledgment".

B Not here. segregable information: Information that can be separated from protected material for release. The usual combination is "identify segregable information".

C Correct. responsive record: A record falling within the request's description. The usual combination is "identify responsive records".

D Not here. retention schedule: A rule or policy governing how long records are retained and disposed of. The usual combination is "follow the retention schedule".

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D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Found records are not automatically cleared records". Cole: "I can flag the affected files for review. I would rather not send a blanket withholding message before anyone has looked at the individual details. Is that right?" Imani: [missing response] Cole: "Then the team should distinguish the contact details from the rest of the contract material, rather than treating each file as indivisible." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. A possible exemption needs review against the actual information and applicable standard. Personal details do not automatically settle the treatment of every page in those files.

A Correct. This is Imani's response in turn 6. It connects Cole's preceding point with Cole's follow-up. Exemption requires assessment against the information and legal standard, not automatic full-file withholding.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Cole says: "The request is for signed service contracts and their attachments from January through March. We have not been asked for every email about the projects." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Cole says: "Then the team should distinguish the contact details from the rest of the contract material, rather than treating each file as indivisible." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Cole says: "I need to correct our F77 acknowledgment. We located eight files, but the letter promised every page. Two contain personal contact details that have not been reviewed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 82

E / Conversation

1. responsive records

Turn 2. Responsive records match the request; locating them does not clear every part for disclosure.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. request scope

Turn 4. Request scope defines the contracts, attachments, and date range, keeping the search boundaries explicit.

3. exemption

Turn 6. Exemption requires assessment against the information and legal standard, not automatic full-file withholding.

4. segregable information

Turn 8. Segregable information can be separated from protected material, allowing responsible reviewers to assess release of nonprotected portions.

5. records preservation

Turn 10. Records preservation keeps sources intact; disclosure preparation does not authorize changes to the originals.

6. redaction

Turn 12. Redaction removes or masks protected information in the release version while leaving the original record preserved.

7. acknowledgment

Turn 14. Acknowledgment confirms receipt; its mistaken release promise needs correction, not treatment as a disclosure decision.

8. review status

Turn 16. Review status describes the current assessment and pending steps; it should not be replaced by an unsupported release deadline.

9. partial release

Turn 18. Partial release discloses releasable portions while applying any justified withholding under the completed assessment.

10. administrative appeal

Turn 20. Administrative appeal is the agency-level review route for an initial decision, distinct from the present progress update.

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07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What is the right response to a proposed full-file withholding?

A. Ask for the applicable basis and assess whether releasable portions can be separated.

The responsible assessment must address the basis and possible partial disclosure, not merely the presence of sensitive material.

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F2. What should remain intact?

B. The source records under applicable preservation requirements

Release preparation does not authorize alteration or destruction of the underlying agency records.

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F / Guided speaking

1. C44

Liaison: The request reference is C44.

Turn 1. C44 is the tracking reference supplied for this separate records request.

2. six responsive files

Officer: The search found six responsive files.

Turn 2. Six files match the stated request scope, but responsiveness does not establish disclosure clearance.

3. April

Liaison: The requested month is April.

Turn 3. April is the time boundary stated for the final inspection reports.

4. not yet made

Officer: The disclosure decision is not yet made.

Turn 4. The record explicitly leaves release and withholding undecided pending the responsible review.

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07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Found records are not automatically cleared records". Cole: "The requester may feel we are changing our position after promising full release. How should I explain the correction?" Imani: [missing response] Cole: "Should we give a new release date now, so the correction does not sound vague?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Correct the acknowledgment directly. Say that the earlier automatic-release assurance was inaccurate, that eight responsive files were located, and that disclosure review is still underway.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Cole says: "The request is for signed service contracts and their attachments from January through March. We have not been asked for every email about the projects." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Imani's response in turn 14. It connects Cole's preceding point with Cole's follow-up. Acknowledgment confirms receipt; its mistaken release promise needs correction, not treatment as a disclosure decision.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Cole says: "I can flag the affected files for review. I would rather not send a blanket withholding message before anyone has looked at the individual details. Is that right?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Cole says: "I need to correct our F77 acknowledgment. We located eight files, but the letter promised every page. Two contain personal contact details that have not been reviewed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What do the 400 attendances count?

A. Visits, including repeat visits

The attendance count includes repeat visits and therefore is not a unique-person or employment count.

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A2. What is the current respondent employment rate?

B. 50%

One hundred five employed respondents divided by two hundred ten respondents equals fifty percent.

Return to the exercise, page 89

A3. How much does the requested budget exceed current spending?

B. $40,000, or 20%

The difference is forty thousand, and forty thousand divided by two hundred thousand is twenty percent.

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D / Response choices

D1. Which headline is supported?

B. Reported employment among respondents rose from 40% to 50%; response coverage changed.

The supported headline keeps the respondent denominator and acknowledges the changed response coverage.

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D2. How should the employment-rate difference be stated?

D. Ten percentage points, equivalent to a 25% relative increase from 40%

Fifty minus forty equals ten points; ten divided by the forty-percent baseline equals twenty-five percent.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The amount spent under the stated accounting basis and period. Which term fits?

D. actual expenditure

A Not here. respondent: A person who supplies a survey response. The usual combination is "identify respondents".

B Not here. impact: A broader or causally attributed effect, depending on the evaluation definition. The usual combination is "assess program impact".

C Not here. attribution: Assignment of an observed result to a particular cause. The usual combination is "support causal attribution".

D Correct. actual expenditure: The amount spent under the stated accounting basis and period. The usual combination is "report actual expenditure".

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D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome". Luis: "Walk me through that measure. I want the numerator and denominator stated before we describe an improvement." Faye: [missing response] Luis: "That gives forty percent and fifty percent among respondents. It does not tell us the employment rate among everyone invited." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. In the earlier cohort, eighty of two hundred respondents reported employment at ninety days. In the current cohort, one hundred five of two hundred ten respondents reported employment at the same follow-up point.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Luis says: "Keep the useful results, but make the limits readable. A careful explanation will help the reviewer understand what the evidence can and cannot support." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Luis says: "Do we have a reliable count of distinct participants, or are those repeat visits still mixed together?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Luis says: "The draft says employment improved by ten percent. That wording could be read differently from the calculation we just made." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Faye's response in turn 6. It connects Luis's preceding point with Luis's follow-up. Cohort identifies the group followed in a particular period, making clear that the two survey results concern different groups.

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E / Conversation

1. output

Turn 2. Output is a direct count of services delivered; twenty workshops describes activity rather than a demonstrated change in residents' circumstances.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. unique participant

Turn 4. Unique participant counts each person once; the four-hundred attendance total includes repeat visits and cannot supply that count.

3. cohort

Turn 6. Cohort identifies the group followed in a particular period, making clear that the two survey results concern different groups.

4. denominator

Turn 8. Denominator is the respondent count used in the employment calculation, not the larger invited population or the attendance total.

5. percentage points

Turn 10. Percentage points expresses fifty percent minus forty percent; it differs from the relative increase based on the starting rate.

6. response rate

Turn 12. Response rate divides responses by invitations: 200/250 is 80%, while 210/300 is 70%.

7. Nonresponse bias

Turn 14. Nonresponse bias may arise if respondents differ systematically from those not responding; the changed coverage warrants examination rather than assumed representativeness.

8. attribution

Turn 16. Attribution assigns the observed change to the program; these cohort observations alone do not establish causation.

9. budget request

Turn 18. Budget request proposes future funding; here it exceeds current spending by forty thousand dollars, or twenty percent.

10. measurement plan

Turn 20. Measurement plan specifies future evidence collection and interpretation, addressing gaps rather than overstating the current findings.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which comparison describes survey response?

B. Previous 80%; current 70%

Two hundred of two hundred fifty is eighty percent; two hundred ten of three hundred is seventy percent.

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F2. What does the budget request still need?

D. A costed delivery and measurement plan with limits stated

Past activity counts and limited outcome observations do not alone establish the future plan or its funding authorization.

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F / Guided speaking

1. 30%

Analyst: The earlier respondent employment rate is 30%.

Turn 1. Thirty divided by one hundred equals thirty percent among respondents.

2. 40%

Reviewer: The later respondent employment rate is 40%.

Turn 2. Forty-eight divided by one hundred twenty equals forty percent among respondents.

3. 10 percentage points

Analyst: The increase in those rates is 10 percentage points.

Turn 3. Forty percent minus thirty percent is ten percentage points, not a ten-percent relative change.

4. $30,000

Reviewer: The requested funding increase is $30,000.

Turn 4. One hundred eighty thousand minus one hundred fifty thousand equals thirty thousand dollars.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome". Luis: "So the observed respondent rate improved while survey coverage fell. We should not hide either part of that picture." Faye: [missing response] Luis: "The draft says the workshops drove the increase. I see a before-and-after comparison, but no estimate of what would have happened without the program." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Agreed. Nonresponse bias is a question to assess, not a result we can quantify from these figures alone. We need better information about missing responses and differences between the groups.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Luis says: "That gives forty percent and fifty percent among respondents. It does not tell us the employment rate among everyone invited." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Luis says: "The workshop count tells me what we delivered. Before we ask for two hundred forty thousand next year, show me what we know about the people who attended." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Luis says: "How many people were invited to respond in each cohort? Different response patterns could affect the comparison." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Faye's response in turn 14. It connects Luis's preceding point with Luis's follow-up. Nonresponse bias may arise if respondents differ systematically from those not responding; the changed coverage warrants examination rather than assumed representativeness.

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Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Published explanatory material reflecting the presently applicable position. Which term fits?

D. current guidance

A Not here. implementation date: The planned or required start of operational delivery. The usual combination is "confirm the implementation date".

B Not here. public comment: Input submitted through an announced public consultation process. The usual combination is "submit public comment".

C Not here. supporting evidence: Documents or information used to substantiate a claim. The usual combination is "identify supporting evidence".

D Correct. current guidance: Published explanatory material reflecting the presently applicable position. The usual combination is "consult current guidance".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A person's first opportunity to speak in the relevant round. Which term fits?

B. initial turn

A Not here. oral submission: Input delivered by speaking. The usual combination is "record an oral submission".

B Correct. initial turn: A person's first opportunity to speak in the relevant round. The usual combination is "complete initial turns".

C Not here. consultation: A process of seeking input before or during decision development. The usual combination is "conduct a consultation".

D Not here. clarification: An explanation resolving ambiguity in a statement or process. The usual combination is "request clarification".

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Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The proposal has not changed the current application test". Amina: "I do not want a question at the desk to be recorded as a final rejection. I am trying to understand the process." Theo: [missing response] Amina: "Are there other conditions beyond residence? The proposal headline makes the program sound much simpler." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. This is not an eligibility determination. I can show you the actual application and review steps, including where to obtain case-specific information within the program's process.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Amina says: "Both files look official. I took the shorter period to mean the rules had changed. Nothing on this printout explains the difference to me." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Theo's response in turn 10. It connects Amina's preceding point with Amina's follow-up. Eligibility determination is an authorized qualification decision, which this information conversation does not issue.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Amina says: "This came from your grant page. It says six months of residence, and I have been here nine. Have I been using the wrong application guidance?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Amina says: "Then I should keep the two documents separate and not rely on the proposed six-month period for the current requirements." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 25

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Give the next speaker a fair turn". Rosa: "I will call the next initial speaker, restate the allocation, and explain that the written route remains available." Ian: [missing response] Rosa: "Before closing, we also need to say who makes the decision and where people can find the next-stage information." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. I will update the meeting record and check that summaries retain their meaning. Recording a concern does not mean the office endorses it, but it should not be lost.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Rosa says: "Could we promise them another opportunity at the end, so they are less frustrated now?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Rosa says: "One resident asked whether the amount of applause will determine the result. We should correct that before the next speaker." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Rosa says: "Another participant has asked for an adjustment so they can follow and contribute to the discussion. How should I respond?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Ian's response in turn 18. It connects Rosa's preceding point with Rosa's follow-up. Meeting record preserves the contributions and procedural actions so the later decision process has an accurate account.

Return to the exercise, page 25

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A supplier submitting an offer in response to a solicitation. Which term fits?

D. offeror

A Not here. award authority: The person or body empowered to authorize the contract award. The usual combination is "confirm award authority".

B Not here. scoring matrix: A structured record of scores against criteria. The usual combination is "reconcile the scoring matrix".

C Not here. strength: An assessed favorable feature under an evaluation criterion. The usual combination is "substantiate a strength".

D Correct. offeror: A supplier submitting an offer in response to a solicitation. The usual combination is "evaluate the offeror".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A defined grouping of planned or reported costs. Which term fits?

A. budget category

A Correct. budget category: A defined grouping of planned or reported costs. The usual combination is "reconcile budget categories".

B Not here. grant award: Funding provided under specified terms for an approved purpose. The usual combination is "identify the grant award".

C Not here. reconciliation: Comparison of records to identify and explain differences. The usual combination is "complete the reconciliation".

D Not here. indirect cost: A cost supporting multiple activities rather than one readily identified objective. The usual combination is "review indirect costs".

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Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Give the next speaker a fair turn". Rosa: "Please remind me of the exact deadline. I do not want to give two different times in the same meeting." Ian: [missing response] Rosa: "One resident asked whether the amount of applause will determine the result. We should correct that before the next speaker." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. The submission deadline is Friday at 17:00 local time. We should repeat the same time and submission instructions so that people can use that route reliably.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Rosa says: "The clerk's summary says that residents cannot reach the site in the evening. Only one person has made that claim so far." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Ian's response in turn 10. It connects Rosa's preceding point with Rosa's follow-up. Submission deadline is Friday at 17:00 local time, the announced cutoff for written input in this fictional meeting.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Rosa says: "One supports the proposal and the other opposes it. We need to make clear that this is not about either position." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Rosa says: "I heard their concerns. Now I need to move the meeting on without making it sound as though disagreement costs someone a turn." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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Review 2 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence". Sana: "If a correction is authorized, keep the original report and the reason for the change. We need a clear history." Owen: [missing response] Sana: "Please send the specific item reference, the missing evidence, and your follow-up status to me before we finalize the submission." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Agreed. A corrected report should be traceable to the review decision. Quietly replacing the number would make it harder to understand what happened and whether the issue was actually resolved.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Sana says: "The submission includes a completeness certification. I do not want us to sign it while ignoring a required missing record." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 18. It connects Sana's preceding point with Sana's follow-up. Corrected report records an authorized revision; the original amount, reason, and approval should remain traceable.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Sana says: "The draft issue note calls it fraud. All we know so far is that the record is missing. I want the wording to reflect that distinction." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Sana says: "Before comparing the figures again, please confirm that we are using the same quarter and the same accounting basis." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The office sending a matter to another responsible team. Which term fits?

C. referring office

A Not here. acknowledgment of receipt: Confirmation that information has arrived. The usual combination is "request acknowledgment of receipt".

B Not here. secure channel: An approved communication route with appropriate safeguards. The usual combination is "use the secure channel".

C Correct. referring office: The office sending a matter to another responsible team. The usual combination is "identify the referring office".

D Not here. request reference: An identifier linking records to the same service request. The usual combination is "quote the request reference".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A concise account of the issue and relevant history. Which term fits?

C. case summary

A Not here. decision deadline: A time by which a decision is due under the applicable process. The usual combination is "verify the decision deadline".

B Not here. application receipt: Confirmation that an application has arrived. The usual combination is "confirm application receipt".

C Correct. case summary: A concise account of the issue and relevant history. The usual combination is "prepare a case summary".

D Not here. constituent service: Assistance connecting people with public processes or offices. The usual combination is "provide constituent service".

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Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The total matches the spreadsheet, not the evidence". Sana: "The draft issue note calls it fraud. All we know so far is that the record is missing. I want the wording to reflect that distinction." Owen: [missing response] Sana: "If you find the record, does that automatically settle whether the grant can pay for the cost?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Call it an unsupported item at this stage. Missing support does not by itself establish intent. We can state exactly what is absent and what we are doing to obtain it.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Sana says: "Please send the specific item reference, the missing evidence, and your follow-up status to me before we finalize the submission." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 10. It connects Sana's preceding point with Sana's follow-up. Unsupported item accurately describes the missing required evidence without asserting fraudulent intent or a final cost decision.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Sana says: "Someone suggested moving the thousand into travel because that category has room in the budget. That would make the report look less awkward." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Sana says: "If you find the record, does that automatically settle whether the grant can pay for the cost?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "A referral that does not send the resident in circles". Tessa: "Please keep both references clear. I do not want the complaint to cause the application to disappear from the system." Ben: [missing response] Tessa: "Then I will expect your Wednesday call about the referral, and the complaint will follow its own review route." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will maintain case continuity while distinguishing the records. When the references and receiving contact are confirmed, I will explain which one to quote for each purpose.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Tessa says: "That would help. But is someone at Public Works taking it on, or will I arrive with another email that nobody has picked up?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 18. It connects Tessa's preceding point with Tessa's follow-up. Case continuity preserves relevant history while keeping the complaint and permit application distinguishable.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Tessa says: "When will I hear from you? I need something more specific than soon because I am planning the shop opening." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Tessa says: "My business is registered, so I thought that office could confirm whether the bench is allowed outside the shop." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The boundaries of the records sought. Which term fits?

C. request scope

A Not here. redaction: Removal or masking of protected information from a released copy. The usual combination is "apply justified redactions".

B Not here. records preservation: Keeping records intact under applicable requirements. The usual combination is "maintain records preservation".

C Correct. request scope: The boundaries of the records sought. The usual combination is "confirm the request scope".

D Not here. attachment: A file or document included with another record. The usual combination is "review the attachments".

Return to the exercise, page 101

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A change or result experienced by the target population. Which term fits?

D. outcome

A Not here. nonresponse bias: Distortion that may arise when respondents differ systematically from nonrespondents. The usual combination is "assess nonresponse bias".

B Not here. budget justification: The evidence and reasoning supporting a funding request. The usual combination is "strengthen the budget justification".

C Not here. follow-up survey: A later survey collecting information after a service or event. The usual combination is "conduct a follow-up survey".

D Correct. outcome: A change or result experienced by the target population. The usual combination is "measure outcomes".

Return to the exercise, page 101

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A referral that does not send the resident in circles". Tessa: "That would help. But is someone at Public Works taking it on, or will I arrive with another email that nobody has picked up?" Ben: [missing response] Tessa: "When will I hear from you? I need something more specific than soon because I am planning the shop opening." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Referral acceptance is not confirmed yet. I will seek that confirmation and identify the responsible contact instead of treating an outgoing email as a completed handoff.

A Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 10. It connects Tessa's preceding point with Tessa's follow-up. Referral acceptance confirms that the receiving office has taken the matter; a sent message alone does not establish this.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Tessa says: "My business is registered, so I thought that office could confirm whether the bench is allowed outside the shop." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Tessa says: "Please keep both references clear. I do not want the complaint to cause the application to disappear from the system." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Tessa says: "When will I hear from you? I need something more specific than soon because I am planning the shop opening." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 101

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Twenty workshops do not prove the outcome". Luis: "Then connect the request to a costed future plan as well. This year's actual spending was two hundred thousand, not two hundred forty thousand." Faye: [missing response] Luis: "Keep the useful results, but make the limits readable. A careful explanation will help the reviewer understand what the evidence can and cannot support." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The budget request is forty thousand higher, a twenty-percent increase. It still needs a delivery plan and explanation of the additional resources, not just a larger activity claim.

A Correct. This is Faye's response in turn 18. It connects Luis's preceding point with Luis's follow-up. Budget request proposes future funding; here it exceeds current spending by forty thousand dollars, or twenty percent.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Luis says: "The workshop count tells me what we delivered. Before we ask for two hundred forty thousand next year, show me what we know about the people who attended." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Luis says: "The draft says the workshops drove the increase. I see a before-and-after comparison, but no estimate of what would have happened without the program." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Luis says: "That gives forty percent and fifty percent among respondents. It does not tell us the employment rate among everyone invited." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 101

Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. quorum

Turn 2. Quorum is the minimum presence required to conduct the business; five members were present, exceeding the fictional committee's requirement of four.

2. amendment

Turn 4. The amendment changed the proposed pilot's duration from six months to three; adopting that change did not adopt the pilot itself.

3. majority

Turn 6. A majority here means more than half of votes actually cast; the fictional rule excludes abstentions, so three affirmative votes are needed when four votes are cast.

4. abstention

Turn 8. An abstention records that a present member did not vote; under these supplied rules it is excluded from votes cast rather than counted as a no.

5. main motion as amended

Turn 10. The main motion as amended is the substantive proposal with the adopted change incorporated; it still needed its own successful vote, which it did not receive.

6. roll-call vote

Turn 14. A roll-call vote identifies individual members' recorded responses; it supports verification of the totals and preserves the distinction among yes, no, and abstention.

Return to the conversation, page 104

Transfer exchange

1. five

Clerk: The quorum requirement is five members.

Turn 1. The supplied requirement is five, which is met by the six members present.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. 5

Chair: The number of votes actually cast is 5.

Turn 2. Three yes plus two no makes five votes; the abstention is excluded under this stated rule.

3. 3

Clerk: The number of affirmative votes is 3.

Turn 3. The motion received three yes votes, which is more than half of the five votes cast.

4. adopted

Chair: Under this rule, the motion is adopted.

Turn 4. Three of five votes is a majority, so the stated adoption requirement is satisfied.

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Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. encumbrances

Turn 2. Encumbrances reserve budget for outstanding commitments under this report's basis; the 38,000 is not included in the 62,000 expenditure and is not freely available for new orders.

2. appropriation

Turn 4. The appropriation is the stipulated 120,000 spending authority in this example; it is distinct from both money already spent and the department's bank balance.

3. final invoice

Turn 6. The final invoice is the accepted 12,000 charge for the completed order; recording it uses twelve thousand of the amount previously reserved.

4. budgetary basis

Turn 8. The budgetary basis defines how this report treats expenditure and outstanding reservations; using the same stipulated basis prevents double counting or mixing it with cash or financial-statement measures.

5. unencumbered balance

Turn 10. The unencumbered balance is the amount available after recorded expenditure and remaining reservations on this report's basis: 120,000 minus 74,000 minus 23,000 equals 23,000.

6. release of encumbrance

Turn 14. A release of encumbrance removes budget reserved for an obligation no longer outstanding; it does not itself describe a cash receipt or supplier refund.

Return to the conversation, page 108

Transfer exchange

1. 15

Manager: Before the final invoice, available budget is $15 thousand.

Turn 1. Ninety minus forty minus thirty-five equals fifteen thousand available before the order closes.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. 48

Analyst: Revised expenditure is $48 thousand.

Turn 2. The final eight-thousand invoice increases recorded expenditure from forty to forty-eight thousand.

3. 25

Manager: Remaining encumbrances are $25 thousand.

Turn 3. The entire ten-thousand reservation for the completed order leaves the outstanding thirty-five-thousand balance.

4. 17

Analyst: Revised available budget is $17 thousand.

Turn 4. Ninety minus forty-eight minus twenty-five equals seventeen thousand, a two-thousand increase from the released unused reservation.

Return to the conversation, page 111

Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. supporting evidence

Turn 2. Supporting evidence is one of the three accepted address documents in this fictional process; the notice must not turn an alternative list into a requirement to supply all three.

2. one of

Turn 4. One of expresses an alternative choice among the listed documents; it prevents the three acceptable options from becoming three cumulative requirements.

3. received by

Turn 6. Received by makes arrival the deadline condition; merely sending or postmarking the submission before the cutoff does not satisfy this fictional process.

4. submission routes

Turn 8. Submission routes identify the authorized ways to provide the material: the renewal portal or Service Desk; simplifying the notice must not remove an available route.

5. active voice

Turn 10. Active voice makes the actor and action explicit, as in Submit your signed renewal form; it improves clarity without altering what the process requires.

6. receipt confirmation

Turn 12. Receipt confirmation shows that a submission arrived and provides its reference; it does not establish completeness, eligibility, or approval of the renewal.

Return to the conversation, page 113

Transfer exchange

1. one

Editor: The applicant chooses one of the two address documents.

Turn 1. The notice gives two alternative address documents, not a requirement to submit both.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. application

Officer: The chosen document accompanies the signed application.

Turn 2. The application is required in addition to one accepted address document.

3. 16:00

Editor: Both items must arrive by 16:00 local time on 6 November.

Turn 3. The exact supplied cutoff is 16:00, not midnight or merely a posting date.

4. receipt

Officer: The reference number confirms receipt.

Turn 4. The scenario explicitly limits the reference to receipt and does not make it an approval.

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Find a phrase by purpose

Policy Implementation and Program Rules

Acknowledge the confusion: I can see why these two documents are easy to confuse.

Identify the current source: G4 explains the requirements that currently apply.

Name the proposal: P2 is a proposed change, not an adopted rule.

Full phrase bank, page 7

Public Meetings and Stakeholder Input

Acknowledge the contribution: Thank you; your concern has been recorded.

Recall the process: We announced one initial turn each before second turns.

Name the waiting group: Five registered speakers have not yet been heard.

Full phrase bank, page 17

Procurement and Vendor Selection

Ask for the rationale: What does best value mean under this selection method?

Return to the criteria: Let us use the published evaluation factors.

Check the arithmetic: The weighted scores total eighty-six for A and eighty-two for B.

Full phrase bank, page 30

Grants, Compliance, and Reporting

Identify the award: We are reconciling the quarterly report for G62.

State the reported total: The report shows forty-eight thousand dollars.

State the supported total: The assembled records support forty-seven thousand dollars.

Full phrase bank, page 41

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Interagency Coordination

Name the gap: Each office assumed the other would contact the resident.

Assign the lead: Jon will own the resident update.

Set the external time: The resident update is at 15:00 local time.

Full phrase bank, page 55

Constituent Services and Escalation

Acknowledge the history: You have already been redirected repeatedly.

Take responsibility for clarification: I will confirm the correct intake route before sending you elsewhere.

Explain the first office: Licensing handles business registration.

Full phrase bank, page 66

Transparency, Records, and Ethics

State the search result: We located eight responsive contract files.

Retain the request scope: The request covers signed contracts and attachments from January through March.

Separate stages: Located does not mean cleared for release.

Full phrase bank, page 81

Performance Metrics and Budget Justification

State the funding request: We are requesting two hundred forty thousand dollars for next year.

Compare with actual spending: This year we spent two hundred thousand dollars.

Quantify the increase: The request is forty thousand dollars higher, a twenty-percent increase.

Full phrase bank, page 92

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References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

[1] Office of the Federal Register. A Guide to the Rulemaking Process.

Background on proposals, public comments, and final rules. Fictional program conditions are not actual eligibility rules or a universal account of rulemaking. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://uploads.federalregister.gov/uploads/2013/09/The-Rulemaking-Process.pdf

[2] Federal Acquisition Regulation 15.304. Evaluation factors and significant subfactors.

Background on disclosed evaluation factors and their importance in U.S. federal negotiated procurement. The invented scoring example is not a universal selection method. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://www.acquisition.gov/far/15.304

[3] Electronic Code of Federal Regulations. 2 CFR 200.302: Financial management.

Background on federal-award financial records and source documentation. The fictional reporting categories and figures illustrate reconciliation language, not cost allowability decisions. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-2/subtitle-A/chapter-II/part-200/subpart-D/section-200.302

[4] FOIA.gov. Frequently Asked Questions.

Background on U.S. federal records requests, review, exemptions, and partial disclosure. The records dialogue does not determine an exemption or prescribe local-law procedures. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://www.foia.gov/faq.html

Companion course

The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.

https://englishladder.com/efsp-government-public-administration.html

Explain the process clearly. Make public decisions understandable.

Eight public-service conversations: distinguish a proposal from current guidance, manage a public meeting, explain a procurement evaluation, reconcile a grant report, assign an interagency handoff, repair a resident referral, review a records response, and connect spending to measurable outcomes.

Policy Implementation and Program Rules

A proposal may be public without being in effect. A publication date does not necessarily establish adoption or applicability. Here G4 describes the current condition, while P2 remains an unadopted proposal with no effective date.

Public Meetings and Stakeholder Input

A consultation can collect evidence, experiences, and arguments without being a referendum. Do not describe applause, speaker counts, or the most forceful contribution as a binding vote when the announced process gives decision authority elsewhere.

Procurement and Vendor Selection

The scores are already weighted. Do not apply the 50/30/20 maxima a second time. The totals are 86 and 82. A higher score is relevant under this method, but the permitted trade-off still needs a reasoned record of the benefits and premium.

Grants, Compliance, and Reporting

A reported total can add correctly while its supporting evidence remains incomplete. Here the category figures total $48,000, but the assembled support totals $47,000. The discrepancy is specifically a $1,000 personnel item, not a general arithmetic error.

Explain the process clearly. Make public decisions understandable. / continued

Phil Stilwell

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